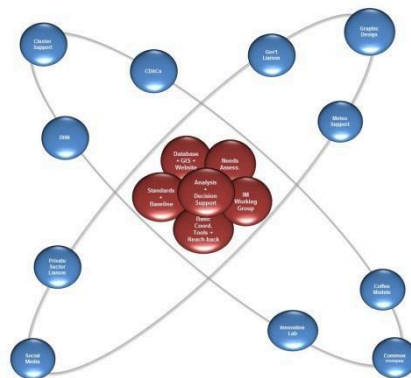


Humanitarian Information Centre 2.0

Blueprint

OCHA Information Services Section

2/4/2013



Humanitarian Information Centres 2.0



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HIC 2.0 Executive Summary

Key Messages

- Information coordination has been consistently under-resourced at the field level; response evaluations from both natural disasters and on-going conflicts repeatedly expose this reality.
- Within the Transformative Agenda, the IASC has requested that OCHA reactivate Humanitarian Information Centres to enhance information management capacity and increase predictability
- The information coordination environment has changed significantly in recent years with increased mobile technology, and internet connectivity translating into increased expectations around the role and quality of information in emergencies.
- The proposed HIC 2.0 approach will deliver predictable information support to the Humanitarian Program Cycle.
- The new HIC includes core modules such database, mapping and assessment support, while also providing new functionality through social media platforms, the use of global volunteer networks, and co-working spaces.

Why do we need the HIC?

The international humanitarian response system has achieved significant gains in recent decades. Under the guidance of the Inter Agency Standing Committee (IASC) and anchored by the Geneva Conventions, humanitarian response had made great strides in saving lives following major disasters and during warfare, and reducing the effects of future disasters. However amidst these advances, information management and coordination systems remain weak.

Recent internal OCHA reviews, as well as independent external evaluations have confirmed that existing information systems require additional resources, integration, and connection to humanitarian decision-making at the field level. Recognizing this reality, OCHA has embarked on a restructuring of its information services to upgrade its usage of information across the organization. The IASC has responded to the information challenge by supporting a range of initiatives around assessments, accountability and information coordination embodied in the Transformative Agenda. As a part of the Transformative Agenda, the IASC has requested that OCHA reactivate Humanitarian Information Centres (HICs) to enhance information coordination in emergencies.

What is HIC 2.0?

The redesigned HIC, referred to in the document as 'HIC 2.0', is a set of systems designed to support all aspects of the Humanitarian Programme Cycle at the field level by delivering analytical information products for decision makers. HIC 2.0 includes core elements such as needs assessment support for the inter-agency assessment process (MIRA), database development, mapping, and coordination tools. HIC 2.0 will also include a new set of functions to meet today's rapidly changing information environment. These advances will include use elements such as social media, infographic design and a common workspace to encourage collaboration among information professionals across organisations. The revised HIC system will be modular to allow light footprint deployment to small emergencies, while also delivering a full suite of enhanced services for major disasters. Today's HIC will be networked to remote expertise as well as capacity in the emergency context, will operate where possible using the principles of open data, and will enhance existing analytical information coordination capacity.

Why redesign the HICs now?

Today's response environment is characterized by convergence of internet and mobile technologies, empowering the world's citizens to access, share and compile information with unprecedented sophistication. This acceleration of ideas, connectivity and awareness translates into increasing expectations for humanitarian responders, to quickly assess what is needed, provide timely and appropriate aid, and provide constant messages about the response and outcomes to headquarters, donors, and the global media market. Complicating these trends, new actors operate across natural disasters and complex emergencies, while aid workers are at increasing risk, often targeted as they carry out their work.

In response to this complexity, the humanitarian system must advance its information systems as one aspect of its evolution. The redesigned HIC will once again be an integral part to information coordination at the field level by providing a predictable set of tools and services in support of humanitarian programs. The HIC minimises complexity by making information support a routine part of the response cycle. The HIC aims to make information coordination habitual by inculcating a standard set of tools that mirrors and supports the predictability that has now developed around the Flash and Consolidated Appeal processes.

How will OCHA build and fund the new HIC?

OCHA proposes an organisational change process to create buy-in to the new HIC concept within the organisation and with external partners, as support with donors is built through a parallel process. This document provides a blueprint for the revised HIC concept to be used by OCHA Information Services Section (ISS) as a basis for tailored messages for internal and external audiences. As a first step ISS will present the concepts within the newly created Information Services Branch (ISB) and then move to build consensus on deployments and funding with the Coordination Response Division (CRD).

OCHA will prove the HIC concept by successfully deploying one or more HICs in 2013. These deployments must be conceptually and financial supported by OCHA funding systems. Through advocacy and success in the field, ISS will re-build donor engagement and support for the HIC concept.

Introduction

This document is a strategic plan for the revision of the Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs' (OCHA) Humanitarian Information Centres (HIC). The document builds on the HIC Current Status document, and defines a **blueprint for core products and services (Core Modules)**, as well as **optional additional functions (Additional Modules)** that the HIC will provide in the context of the IASC Transformative Agenda. The document also defines the **human, financial, and institutional requirements** to deliver these functions in 2013 and beyond.

This document designs a set of systems, products and services that make up a HIC. OCHA will need to invest time and resources into the construction of these mechanisms, and consistently maintain and refine the HIC concept over time. These changes should be reflected in updated versions of the HIC 2.0 document.

Target: The document targets Information Management Staff who would be tasked with deploying a HIC in 2013 and beyond. This is an internal OCHA ISS document. From this blueprint, ISS can produce targeted messaging, promotional and advocacy materials.

Out of Scope: The document is not designed to convince the reader of the utility of the redesigned HIC, but rather to elaborate the nature and components of the redesigned HIC. Clarifying these elements within ISS is the first step towards advocacy and securing consistent funds for the HIC system.

Assumptions: The document assumes that the reader is familiar with familiar with OCHA's information management tools and product and the HIC Current Status document. The document is designed so that additional detail can be added to each section over time, as planning develops and moves towards a granular level. OCHA must dedicate additional human and financial resources to build the HIC 2.0 concept before it can be deployed at the field level. Estimates of these resource needs are included in the document.

Humanitarian Context

OCHA is redesigning the HIC to meet the demands of a rapidly changing humanitarian response environment. The paragraphs below are not exhaustive, but serve to highlight relevant trends that will influence HIC 2.0 and distinguish it from previous deployments.

Humanitarian Reform and Transformative Agenda: The Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC) Humanitarian Reform agenda of 2005 was designed to make humanitarian response more predictable through the Cluster Approach, a system of sectoral coordination with clear leadership responsibility. The *Operational Guidance on Responsibilities of Cluster/Sector Leads & OCHA in Information Management* mandates Cluster Lead Agencies to manage information within their respective Clusters, while OCHA is responsible for inter-Cluster information management. OCHA reduced the deployment frequency, and then informally shelved the HIC in response to this development.

The IASC's 2011 Transformative Agenda is a set of concrete actions designed to build on the Cluster Approach to improve the timeliness and effectiveness of humanitarian response. Evaluations that led to the adoption of the Transformative Agenda acknowledged continued weaknesses in, and suggested a renewed focus on, information management to support predictability and accountability through the Humanitarian Program Cycle. As part of the Agenda, the IASC requested the return of the HIC with the expectation that stronger capacity could address these weaknesses.

Evolving Mobile Technology Platforms – As mobile communications technology continues to proliferate and fall in price, humanitarian aid recipients have increasing access to mobile technology, with 78 per cent of people in

developing countries having access to a cell phone¹. Across the world, more data is being generated across all industries, including humanitarian response.

Increasing Internet Availability – While Europe and America have the highest proportion of Internet users among their entire populations, developing countries, where HICs are more likely to deploy, have the greatest overall number of users. Twenty per cent of households in developing countries now have access to the Internet, with 40 per cent likely to have this access by 2015². The HIC will increasingly rely on mobile and Internet based collection and dissemination of information.

Host Government Involvement – Host government authorities are increasingly involved in both disaster prevention and response operations. These governments are asserting their leadership, moulding international aid towards governmental priorities and demanding greater integration between national and international response efforts. In some cases, a contested relationship exists between host government authorities and national/international Non-Governmental Organizations (NGOs) assisting in the response. This requires additional sensitivity and awareness around information issues in such response environments.

Urban Response Contexts – As urbanization continues, humanitarian response operations are targeting people and communities in complex urban operational environments. Today's HIC will need to take into consideration new response tools and techniques in urban emergencies.

Proliferation of Actors – New actors in humanitarian response environments (inside and outside the IASC Cluster System) include target populations (ever more wired with new technology), digital volunteer communities connected through the internet, and the global network of trade, communications and information meaning that 'the network' itself is now an actor in the humanitarian response environment.

Scarce Resources –Economic downturn in the developed world translates into stagnant budgets for humanitarian response coordination despite increasing global demand for such services.

Insecure Operating Environment –Heightened security concerns among humanitarian actors, particularly in conflict zones have a significant impact on the quality and quantity of data available to support humanitarian operations and coordination. The HIC itself suffered the loss of three staff and much of its infrastructure in the 2003 attack on the United Nations compound in Baghdad. Security will be a major consideration in any future HIC deployments. This is in stark contrast to the 'open door' policy of the first HIC deployed in the 1999 Kosovo crisis where users could enter the HIC premises without a security screening.

Network Evolution – The HIC will operate in a networked environment, where front line responders increasingly connect to organisational headquarters and global volunteer networks in each new emergency. Remote processing of information will increasingly take place in all response environments, as connectivity increases between front line responders and networks of global expertise.

Implications

The humanitarian system is becoming increasingly connected and networked through information technology. This connectivity allows greater information awareness at all levels of the system. Information and ideas move with ever increasing velocity. The humanitarian system is expected to deliver more comprehensive products with greater speed and accuracy. Information that was once delivered in hard copy or via email is now expected to be compatible with mobile devices such as tablets and smart phones.

People impacted by disasters, humanitarian actors, donor organisations, and the general public have access to information allowing greater situational awareness. This greater awareness translates into an increasing number of requests, and ever more sophisticated demands on humanitarian information system. The increasing global convergence of technology, media and transportation means that the humanitarian community, OCHA and the HIC are expected to provide an ever-higher level of coordination support to mirror integration in other global sectors. Disaster affected communities are increasingly expecting the international response effort to include their voices and concerns in all aspects of the relief and recovery process.

¹ International Telecommunications Union (ITU) Broad Band Commission, Page 8 September 2012

² <http://www.aljazeera.com/news/americas/2012/09/2012923232111323871.html> quoting ITU International Telecoms Union (ITU) Broad Band Commission

In this environment, meeting the information needs of OCHA's partners means promoting interoperability through data standards, data exchange languages and protocols. In addition to facilitating open data and information for others to analyse, OCHA must also provide its own analysis to inform trusted decision making for humanitarian leaders.

The HIC 2.0 is part of the overall OCHA response to the challenges of today's operating environment by encouraging exchange standards, supporting the open exchange of data/information and providing decision making support through best in class information management at the field level. The HIC is OCHA's field level mechanism for responding to the evolving information and response context.

Characteristics of HIC 2.0

The mission of the Humanitarian Information Centre is to support the humanitarian community in the systematic and standardized collection, processing and dissemination of information with the aim of improving coordination, situational understanding and decision-making. In undertaking this mission, the HIC will complement the information management capabilities of the national authorities, as well as in-country development and humanitarian actors, in order to optimize the response and meet the needs of the affected population.³

The HIC 2.0 concept is based on the 2008 HIC Terms of Reference (TOR), agreed upon by the IASC, which provides the foundation for HIC services. HIC 2.0 will implement this TOR in the context of the IASC Transformative Agenda. The HIC will facilitate implementation of the Humanitarian Program Cycle with predictable information management support at the field level. Whereas earlier HIC deployments provided products and services on an *ad hoc* basis to meet the needs a wide range of agencies, the HIC 2.0 concept emphasizes analysis to support humanitarian leadership in the planning, implementation and monitoring of a response.

HIC 2.0 is a mechanism for making information management predictable and routine. In addition to establishing systems that underpin the Humanitarian Program Cycle, the HIC will support the humanitarian community with a suite of sophisticated tools and services that support operational and strategic decision-making to save lives and preserve livelihoods in emergencies. The HIC has always been a vibrant and trusted fixture in the response landscape and will continue to play an active role as an honest broker of information for the community as a whole by emphasizing coordination and exchange mechanisms that benefit all levels of the response.

HIC 2.0 can support the OCHA Head of Office in his or her role in moderating and validating the overall information and messaging coming out of an emergency response environment. This quality control or editorial function is strengthened by consistent and reliable information linked to the Humanitarian Programme Cycle.

The revised HIC concept builds on the original HIC system by increasing the number of services offered to the humanitarian community. The HIC 2.0 system improves on the original HIC concept by deploying various sizes of HIC depending on the context, and refocuses the HIC on strategic analysis in support of decision makers in the field.

In addition to the specific functions in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle, HIC 2.0 also acts as a convener on information issues by providing the following:

- A space where the humanitarian community can share and access information resources in order to improve the planning and delivery of humanitarian assistance;
- A provider of information products and services that enable the humanitarian community to deliver assistance more effectively, following principles of good practice in information management;
- A focal point for data collection, analysis and dissemination in support of the provision of humanitarian assistance, developing and supporting common data standards;
- A facilitator for initiatives and activities related to information management in the field, particularly in collaboration with other humanitarian actors in support of existing coordination structures;
- An advocate for a culture of information-sharing in the humanitarian community, generating awareness of good practice and making it possible for agencies to develop common standards and practices in the field.⁴

Figure 1: The Humanitarian Program Cycle

³ IASC Endorsed Terms of Reference for Humanitarian Information Centers, 2008, page 3.

⁴ OCHA IM Handbook for the Field Information Section, Version 2.5 2009, Page 21

Humanitarian Programme Cycle



The Humanitarian Program Cycle defines the high level activities that humanitarian response agencies follow in a field response operation. Needs assessment leads to joint planning, resource mobilisation, implementation, monitoring and a strategic review process. The HIC 2.0 system supports each of these phases with information management systems.

Needs Assessment and Analysis – With the development of the Multi-Cluster Initial Rapid Needs Assessment (MIRA), the IASC has made significant strides in coordinating rapid needs assessment to develop a common understanding of humanitarian need in emergencies. This common assessment approach provides the foundation for needs-based strategic planning and monitoring mechanisms. Information management is an essential part of all MIRA phases, and the HIC will be the focal point for support. In addition to supporting the MIRA process, the HIC will support, where necessary, the detailed cluster assessments that form the basis of the Flash and Consolidated Appeals.

The HIC will link information management experts with professionals with knowledge of humanitarian assessment methodology to undertake activities such as:

- Hosting the assessment registry on www.humanitarianresponse.info;
- Carrying out secondary data analysis;
- Supporting Preliminary Scenario Definition (PSD);
- Survey sampling methodology;
- Building and managing data collection platforms;
- Analysis of survey findings by linking new primary data to baseline common operational datasets, creating a data driven picture of humanitarian need.; and
- Linking the on-going assessment process to the monitoring and evaluation elements of the humanitarian program cycle.

Joint Planning – Using the information developed in the needs assessment and analysis process, the HIC will support joint planning initiatives such as the Common Humanitarian Action Plan (CHAP), contingency planning and other inter-agency response strategies.

This joint planning support may consist of the following outputs:

- Maps and other analytical products that support aid targeting and the development of delivery strategies;
- Development of project-related (i.e. if X project is delivered, the likely outcome is Y) and contingency-planning scenarios; and
- Development of a small number of useful, measurable indicators to be used in the implementation and monitoring phase.

Resource Mobilisation – The HIC delivers information products that enable OCHA and the wider humanitarian community to send clear data-driven messages to donors collectively (i.e. the Flash Appeal, CAP) and at the agency level. The HIC does not directly engage in resource mobilisation activities but will continue to advocate for the use of the OCHA Financial Tracking System (FTS).

Implementation and Monitoring – The HIC will support implementation and monitoring by developing response-level monitoring mechanisms that can aggregate cluster data and provide humanitarian leadership with a continuous picture of response effectiveness.

Specific implementation and monitoring system support includes:

- Encouraging a data-driven monitoring system using commonly developed indicators;
- Advising Clusters and supporting the development of cluster level database systems that systematically gather data using the agreed indicators; and
- Advising and training Cluster teams on data collection and management techniques to ensure that the data collected is meaningful and usable.

Strategic Review & Lessons Learned – The HIC will support the system-wide information systems that allow for quantitative evaluative review and real-time evaluation. Baseline data, needs assessment, agreed indicators and a monitoring system must be in place to enable meaningful evaluation. HIC support to strategic review and lessons learned processes includes the real time evaluation (for correction during response) and outcomes review (for correction in future responses). HIC 2.0 systems will promote accessible, sharable data that independent evaluation teams can access during the evaluative process.

Specific strategic review actions include:

- Aggregating cluster level indicator data to gain a system wide understanding of the program implementation process;
- Identifying trends and explaining their implications to humanitarian decision makers; and
- Reviewing Cluster-level information systems to advise on how to improve these systems in real time, and in future emergencies.

Elements of HIC 2.0

The following elements will guide concept development and implementation of the HIC 2.0 concept:

Simplicity – The HIC should simplify and streamline coordination structures through information design, coordination and technological systems rather than adding an additional layer of coordination to the humanitarian response environment.

Modular Design – The HIC will continue to provide core service modules from previous HIC deployments but will also include new information products and service. These new modules will function as add-ons to the core HIC products and services to meet the challenges of the new operating environment. The modular approach of HIC 2.0 will allow for a wide range of deployment options tailored to the response context. For example, where previous HICs have provided mapping and database coordination services, the HIC 2.0 would supplement these coordination services with a focal point for interaction with the digital volunteer networks, and volunteer translators to support remote translation of operational documents. If required, the HIC would also provide a common workspace to foster collaboration among IM professionals.

Networked Approach – HIC 2.0 will use a networked approach in all activities and systems. HIC 2.0 is crowd accelerated, where networks increase the speed, accuracy and relevance of its products. The HIC 2.0 should link

humanitarian actors to each other, and to a wider range of expertise and support at the headquarters level, and beyond to a global network of volunteers supporting the operation. This approach will leverage OCHA's convening role at the centre of humanitarian response coordination to facilitate information flow and connect humanitarian response actors through data. The HIC should break down information silos that exist within humanitarian information management connecting information flows and allowing information to be shared for joint analysis.

Open data – Wherever possible the HIC will promote the open exchange of data among humanitarian actors, the affected population and host government structures. In line with OCHA's move towards information integration the HIC will connect products and services to customer needs using an open data approach.

Service Mind-set – The HIC will continue to promote service-oriented approach to user needs, seeking to understand what the 'customer' needs and provide timely services and products to meet these needs.

Extension of OCHA – The HIC 2.0 will represent OCHA, and be a 'front office' representation of OCHA reaching out to the humanitarian community. Whereas previous HICs were initially seen as separate from OCHA, HIC 2.0 will be closely integrated with OCHA strategy, methodology and funding mechanisms.

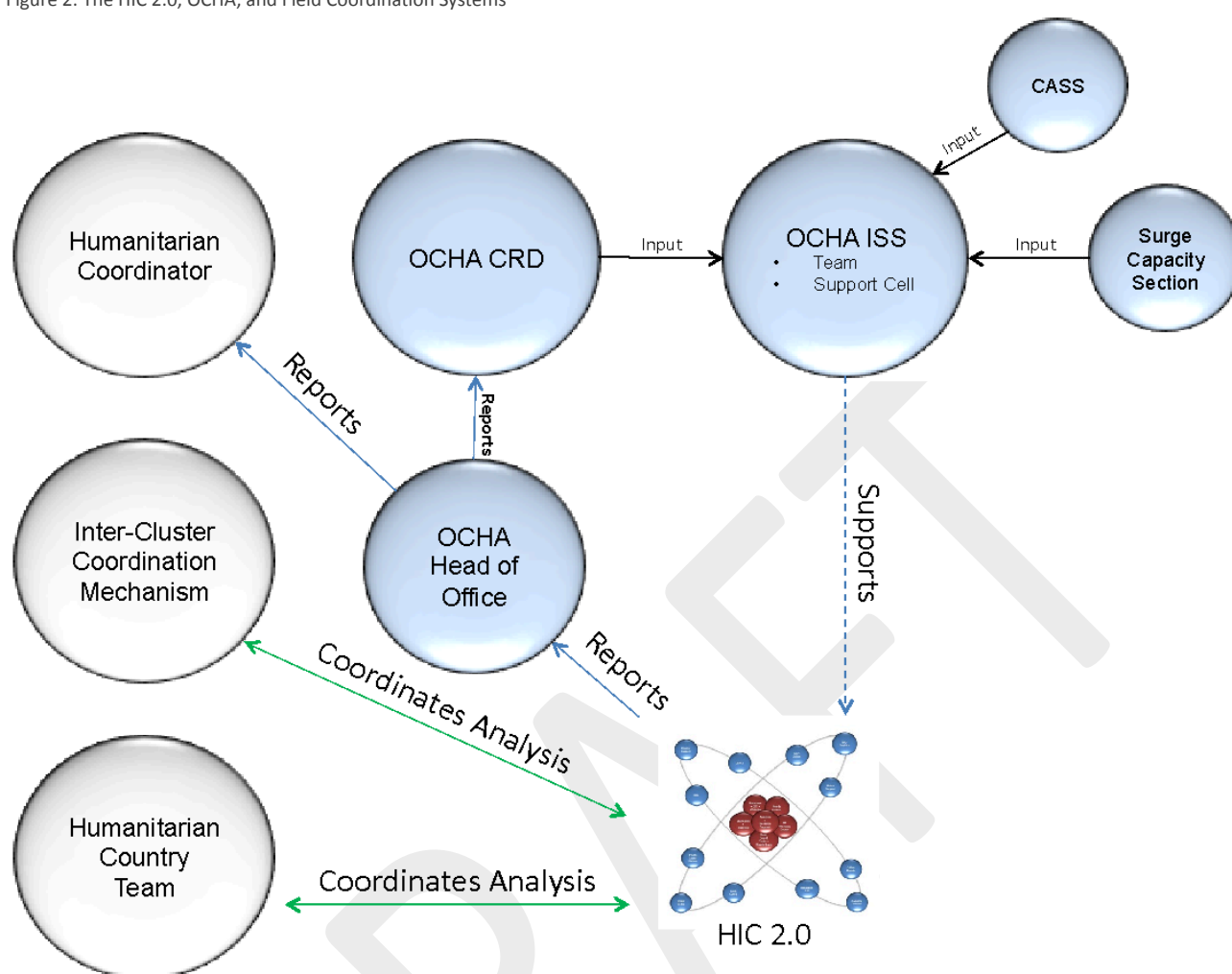
HIC as Mediator – The HIC will act as an interface between information experts with humanitarian response operators, finding the best way to meet the needs of decision makers within the limits of technology and available data. Given this role, the HIC must be staffed with multi-skilled teams using a collaborative approach to solve problems and build capacity.

HIC as Connector – HIC 2.0 provides an effective operational link between information analysis and decision makers in the field. HIC 2.0 bridges this gap by providing predictable analysis products based on the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

The ultimate aim of the HIC is to provide the basic information coordination tools to facilitate humanitarian action while also creating sophisticated analysis to support strategic and operational decision making that saves lives and supports livelihood recovery. Rather than providing services based on the HIC capacity (i.e. what the HIC *can* provide), the HIC will provide sophisticated analysis to support decision-making (i.e. what the HIC *should* provide).

The HIC 2.0, OCHA, and Field Coordination Systems

Figure 2: The HIC 2.0, OCHA, and Field Coordination Systems



As a Humanitarian Common Service, the HIC 2.0 reports to the Resident or Humanitarian Coordinator (RC/HC). In practice the RC/HC has delegated oversight responsibility to the OCHA Head of Office. The HIC 2.0 will continue to coordinate analysis with the needs of the Inter-Cluster Coordination Mechanism, and Humanitarian Country Team.

The HIC and OCHA

The HIC has historically existed as unique from the in-country OCHA office using a separate cost plan, and maintaining distinct branding while fulfilling the HIC terms of reference. HIC 2.0 will link the HIC more closely to OCHA, by providing a concrete set of tools to support OCHA's leadership in the Humanitarian Program Cycle. HIC 2.0 branding will more closely resemble the OCHA brand, signifying the symbiotic relationship between OCHA and HIC 2.0 in supporting the Humanitarian Program Cycle. The revised HIC system will be of direct benefit to OCHA's coordination professionals, more closely aligning information support with programmatic coordination needs.

When explaining the role of HIC 2.0, it is instructive to examine and analyse the terms of reference related to information management across a range of functions. Clear terms of reference exist for HICs⁵, OCHA's Information Management Officers⁶, and for OCHA's information management responsibilities (contained within the Operational Guidance Note for Information Management⁷ (OGN).

All of these terms of reference detail how information management supports the humanitarian community in saving lives and livelihoods in emergencies. The operational guidance note for Information Management gives OCHA the

⁵ <http://www.humanitarianinfo.org/iasc/downloadaddoc.aspx?docID=4911&type=pdf>.

⁶ An example TOR can be found at http://www.internationalpeaceandconflict.org/forum/topics/un-ocha-job-information-management-officer-p3-yemen?xg_source=activity#.UQQzoKU1bFI.

⁷ <http://www.unocha.org/what-we-do/information-management/resources>.

responsibility for inter-Cluster information management, and focuses on information “...as the foundation on which decision-making for a coordinated and effective response is based⁸.” The HIC TORs clearly support this conclusion. The HIC TORs are closely aligned with OGN messages, while emphasising the role of providing information support services to the entire humanitarian community. The Information Management Officer TOR focuses on the role of the individual manager within these structures. This TOR describes mostly support for internal information and content management systems, while also stipulating that the IMO must “Manage information to support OCHA and the UN system, as well as partner organizations, prevent, mitigate, manage, and recover from humanitarian disasters and emergencies⁹.”

While differences exist between these TORs, it is clear that the language and intent of these documents are aligned around decision support, and information coordination for the entire humanitarian community. Therefore the reactivated HIC system complements existing OCHA information support services. The reactivated HIC will provide additional support to these on-going functions.

The HIC and the OCHA Information Management Unit (IMU)

OCHA’s currently deploys Information Management Units at the country level to manage internal humanitarian information systems in support of the OCHA office. These services may provide indirect benefit to the humanitarian community, but are designed to primarily support the OCHA Head of Office with information management functions. While in practice both the HIC and IMU report to the OCHA head of office, the HIC is a Humanitarian Common Service with outwardly facing services for the humanitarian community, while the IMU primarily manages internal information management systems, with a reduced array of services for the humanitarian community at large. When deployed to the field, the HIC will complement existing humanitarian and governmental information management systems in order to avoid duplication, and build on existing systems to better serve affected populations.

The HIC 2.0 development process should undertake the following

1. Define a specific terms of reference for engaging with an OCHA Information Management Unit.
2. Develop a specific product and service list for HIC 2.0 and the IMU when simultaneously deployed in a field location to avoid duplication of effort.

HIC 2.0 Deployment Approach: When is a HIC used?

The HIC and new emergencies

To date a HIC has normally been deployed only in large-scale emergencies according to a set of pre-established triggers. With the proposed modular approach, OCHA will now have the option to deploy a HIC in a wider range of response scenarios where additional information management is needed. This could be a natural disaster of any size where an international response takes place, or a new or on-going conflict where the information environment changes through an escalation or de-escalation of conflict impacting humanitarian needs. A HIC could be deployed in all emergency Levels (1-3) to provide appropriate information design and support.

Level 1 – In Level 1 emergencies, any OCHA response is likely to come from an existing country office or the regional office. If a HIC is established it is likely to be for a short duration of one to three months to address a specific issue such as a flash appeal. In most cases, no HIC will be required in a Level 1 emergency.

Level 2 – In Level 2 emergencies, any OCHA response is likely to be led by a country office, if present, and/or the Regional Office. The HIC 2.0 will deploy a medium equipment module package, to support information management design for the response. The HIC phases out after six to eight months and IM capacity transfers to the national or regional OCHA office. Most support for the HIC is likely to come from an OCHA Country Office or Regional Office rather than from headquarters or the HIC management cell.

Level 3 – OCHA will deploy a Level 3 HIC 2.0 in emergencies with an expected deployment timeframe of up to 12 months. This is level provides the maximum functionality and requires the highest financial cost.

The HIC and on-going emergencies

In protracted emergencies OCHA Information Management Units provide HIC-like services to the humanitarian community in support of OCHA’s mission. The HIC would add capacity to manage information, and bring focus and

⁸ *ibid*, Page 1.

⁹ IMO TOR Example, Page 1.

clarity to information systems and concerns. In practical terms, the HIC would support the Humanitarian Program Cycle in the context of a protracted emergency. These well-resource entities develop context specific systems and services over a life span of several years that support system wide information coordination. Future operations could employ the HIC 2.0 brand to indicate the modular, service oriented nature of this information coordination. The change in branding could be justified as OCHA responding to the 2011 IASC request to reactivate the HIC system, and would harmonize OCHA's global information support services at the field level. Once rebranded, these rebranded HIC 2.0s could directly benefit from the HIC 2.0 Management Cell leadership, roster, and training support. HIC 2.0 entities deployed in chronic emergencies could support innovation and provide consistent test cases for new ideas and help catalyse incremental positive change in the HIC system over time.

In level 2 and 3 emergencies, the HIC deployment may not be externally branded as a HIC, but rather would provide capacity to the OCHA office or national authorities leading the response without a public brand. Level 3 'HIC Large' deployments would always be publicly branded as a HIC.

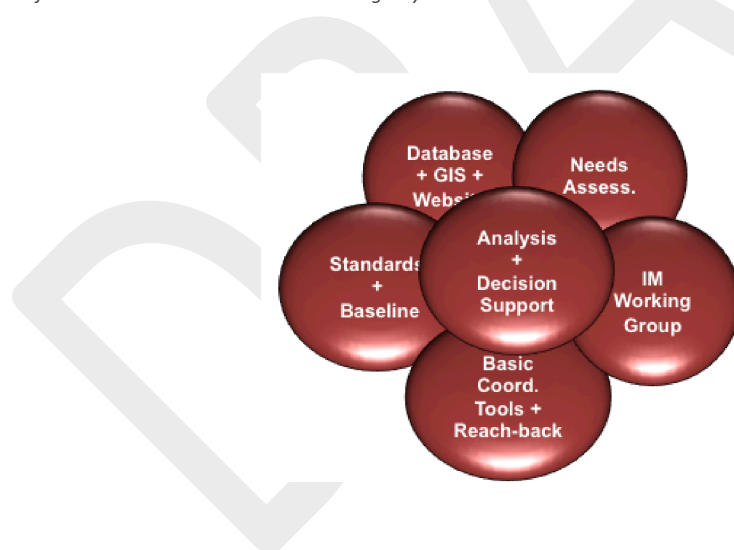
A HIC does not provide remote support and analysis. It is only deployed where OCHA and partners have physical humanitarian access. If access is not possible, OCHA should consider deploying a remote Information Analysis Unit (IAU) to meet coordination and analysis needs. When no humanitarian access exists, remote analysis with information preparedness is the standard OCHA response. This is a case specific and complex issue that OCHA must address on a case-by-case basis.

The graphics below illustrate the 'modular' approach to the variable levels of deployment. A description of each of the modules can be found later in this document.

Level 1

In a Level 1 emergency, the HIC would establish basic services from the HIC 2.0 nucleus services without the additional electron modules, with the assumption that basic services would be adequate to meet the information coordination requirements in a Level 1 emergency.

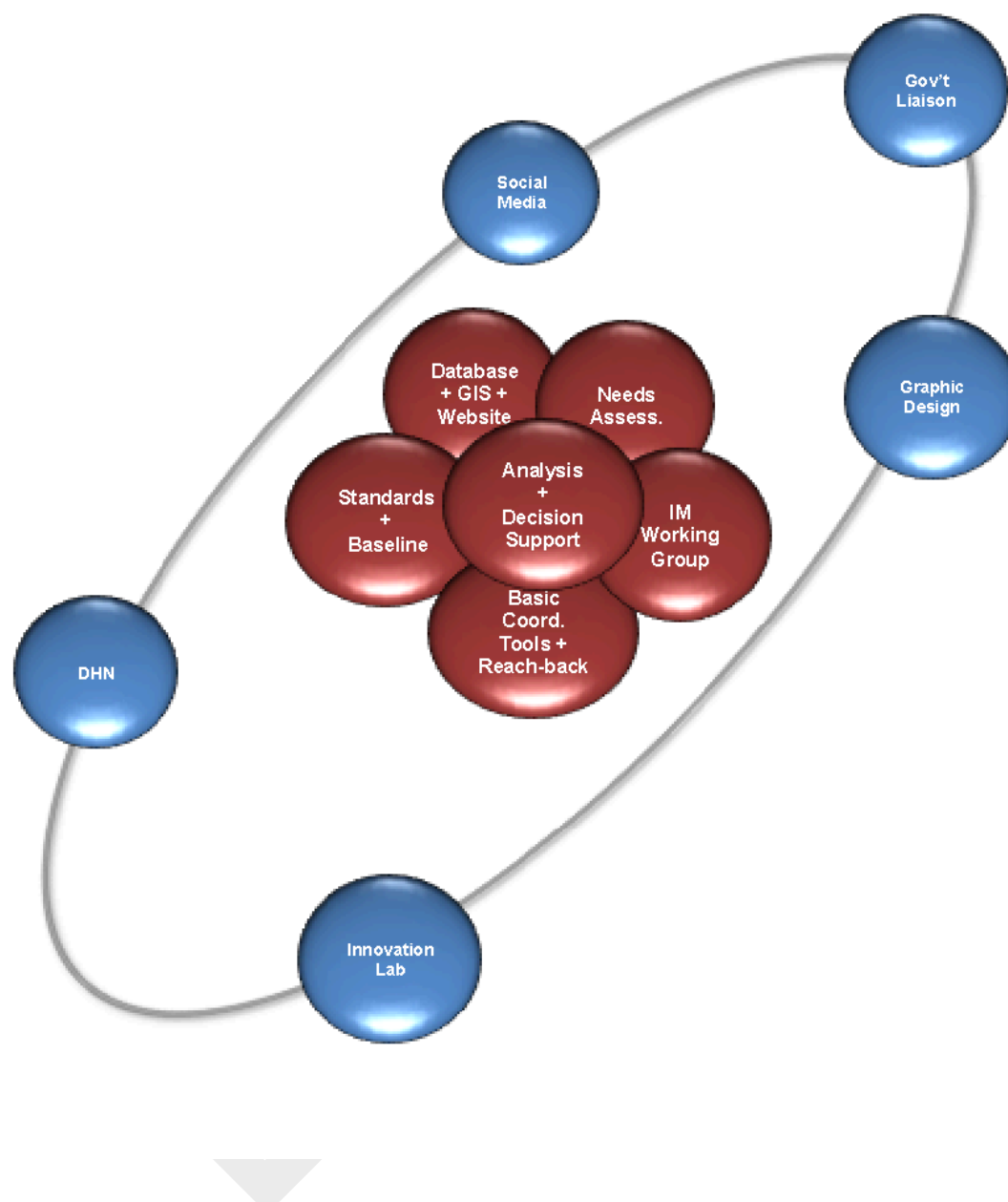
Figure 3: Graphic of the Modular HIC 2.0 in a Level 1 Emergency



Level 2

In a Level 2 Emergency, the HIC would deploy the core nucleus modules shown above, plus relevant electron modules as required by the emergency.

Figure 4: Graphic of the Modular HIC 2.0 in a Level 2 Emergency

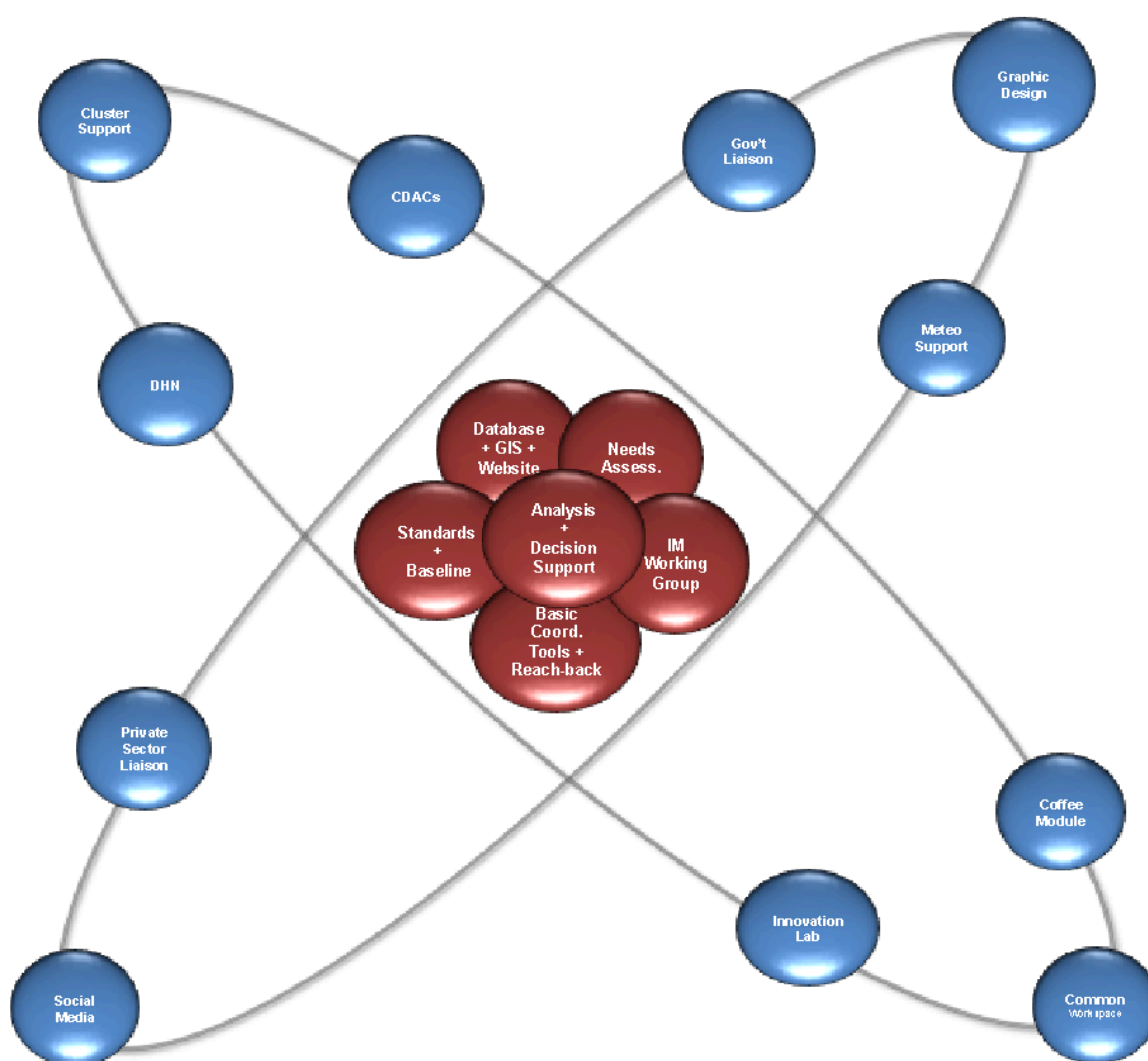


Level 3

The graphic below shows the core HIC products, such as basic coordination tools (3Ws, contact list, meeting schedule), Mapping/GIS, Database, Website, Needs Assessment and Analysis bolstering Decision Support at the centre. This is the nucleus of the HIC atom.

Additional HIC modules, such as Social Media, a Common Workspace, and Digital Humanitarian Network (DHN) can be added as a cloud of electrons circling the HIC nucleus based on operational need. This graphic shows the scalable nature of HIC 2.0. The system is flexible, giving OCHA the ability to tailor the services and functions of a HIC to the specific deployment context.

Figure 5: Graphic of the Modular HIC 2.0 in a Level 3 Emergency



HIC and UNDAC

The United Nations Disaster Assessment and Coordination (UNDAC) team designed to help the United Nations and governments of disaster-affected countries in the initial phase of a sudden onset emergency. UNDAC teams deploy 12 to 48 hours after disaster strikes, and support the RC/HC will provide the affected host government with coordination support.

In addition to UNDAC, OCHA is likely to deploy a Level 1, 2, or 3 HIC 2.0 concurrent to the UNDAC deployment. In Level 3 emergencies, OCHA ISS staff will support UNDAC, and then stand up a HIC 2.0 alongside the OSOCC. Given this close relationship, the HIC Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ Provide UNDAC with a clear message on the mission, deployment process and products/services that HIC 2.0 will provide to the humanitarian community;
- ✓ Work closely with UNDAC colleagues to ensure that the HIC 2.0 development process takes UNDAC systems into account to provide complementary services at all phases of HIC deployment;
- ✓ Consult with UNDAC and IHP partners to ensure that there is agreement to support both a HIC and the UNDAC system;
- ✓ Work with UNDAC and IHP to ensure that the equipment and personnel are available to support two simultaneous Level 3 HIC and UNDAC deployments, as well as additional smaller HIC and UNDAC deployments; and

- ✓ Develop HIC 2.0 deployment modalities that complement the HIC 2.0 deployment process.

The aim of this engagement is to ensure that UNDAC and HIC 2.0 never compete over partner resources, and can support each-other during deployments and as new systems are developed.

Branding

HIC 2.0 should have a distinct logo and brand identity that differentiates HIC 2.0 services from OCHA branding, yet shows the close association between the two entities. The HIC 2.0 logo should have consistent style and presentation across all HIC 2.0 deployments, yet indicate the country of deployment. An example of a HIC 2.0 logo is below, contrasted with a previous HIC logo:

Figure 6: Sketch of the original HIC and HIC 2.0 Logo



Graphic: Craig Williams

The logo and brand identity should show the distinct nature of HIC 2.0 products and services, while placing the HIC 2.0 firmly within the OCHA portfolio.

In addition, each core and optional module (such as Analysis, Meeting Schedule, etc.) should have an icon that defines the service. Over time, this icon will be used consistently in all internal and external references to the module, and will become associated with the services and outputs that the module provides. Suggested icons are provided for each module in the following sections.

The HIC 2.0 development process should undertake the following:

- ✓ A brand discovery and development process where an OCHA staff work with colleagues in the Audio and Visual Media colleagues to undertake a brainstorming exercise to develop the brand identity of HIC 2.0.
- ✓ The HIC Management Cell should use the outcomes of this branding process to develop HIC 2.0 specific publicity material such as flags, stickers and posters. The brand identity should be used on all HIC related products where appropriate.

All materials should use the OCHA standard colour ramps and style patterns to ensure coherence with OCHA's corporate identity and branding approach.

Core Components

Given TOR and outputs listed above, the key components of a HIC are as follows:

Human Resources – The crux of the HIC, this category includes the people who roll out the HIC at the field and those at the headquarters level who ensure consistent deployment readiness as well as the recruitment, development and retention systems to ensure that the human resources capacity exists to support HIC deployment.

Equipment and Logistics – This category includes the physical equipment of the HIC as well as basecamp or other suitable shelter for the deployment conditions. Included are the office materials to support the HIC.

HIC 2.0 Modules (Core and Additional Functions/Products/Services) – These analytical systems include the core OCHA information management tools and standards, will now include additional special projects in information management to support the HIC mandate.

Guidance – This category includes the terms of reference and supporting mandates that make a HIC possible. Although the existing TORs are valid, OCHA must develop new operational and administrative guidance to support HIC 2.0

Funding Considerations – This category concerns HIC 2.0 funding systems. The section will describe overall funding concerns, and define a sample HIC cost plan to use as a planning tool.

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Human Resources

Background

The people deployed to establish and manage the HIC are essential to its success. OCHA must deploy professionals with the right skills in a timely manner, and deployment structures supporting HIC deployment. In recent years, OCHA has created several mechanisms to quickly deploy OCHA staff (Emergency Response Roster ERR), draw from standby partners (Standby Partner Program SBPP) and access pools of qualified humanitarian responders (Associates Surge Pool ASP).¹⁰

Previous HIC staff structures have emphasised technical skills such as GIS/mapping and database development at the expense of communication, liaison, and coordination skills. Today's HIC will require a full portfolio of skills to ensure both technical excellence and effective coordination outreach. Given this reality, the HIC 2.0 design process includes a detailed review of staff capacity to determine appropriate HIC staff profiles.

OCHA will create a virtual roster of qualified professional staff to fill international HIC staff positions within these existing systems. A HIC management cell (see below) will manage this virtual roster by i) identifying clear profiles and terms of reference for all HIC staff ii) reviewing existing capacity within these systems and iii) building capacity with recruitment and training programs within these mechanisms. This approach will establish and maintain consistent staffing flows to support HIC deployment.

Human Resources Required to Develop and Manage HIC 2.0

OCHA must establish a Management Cell to build and manage HIC 2.0 in 2013 and beyond. This Management Cell will consist of staff and budgetary resources. The HIC 2.0 Management Cell will consist of the following functions

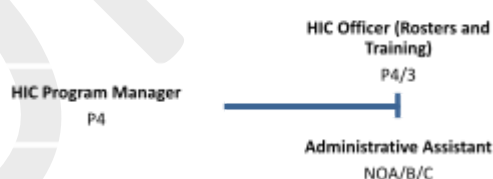
HIC Programme Manager P4 – This team leader position represents the HIC at the national and global levels, provides strategic guidance on HIC 2.0 development projects. The team leader ensures that HIC 2.0 is deployed, managed, and phased out according to the HIC Terms of Reference and HIC 2.0 Design Document.

HIC Officer (Roster and Training) P4/3 – Defines HIC 2.0 staffing needs, develops HIC 2.0 staff profiles, liaises with OCHA surge capacity mechanisms to manage the HIC 2.0 virtual roster system. The HIC officer also conducts capacity building activities to bolster available staff for the HIC 2.0.

Administrative Assistant NOA/B/C – This team member manages all administrative and financial aspects of HIC 2.0 deployment.

The org chart below shows the structure of the HIC 2.0 Management Cell.

Figure 7: HIC Management Cell Org Chart



This management cell could be located in Geneva HQ, New York HQ or in a Global South regional hub depending on the on-going OCHA restructuring process.

Management Cell Costs

The management cell will require a budget to carry out its activities in support of the HIC Terms of Reference and the HIC 2.0 development and deployment process. These costs categories will include the following:

Staff Costs – Staff costs will include two professional positions and one administrative support position.

¹⁰ Explanation of each source is included in HIC Status Review.

Travel – Travel budget includes funds for partner management and liaison missions, and deployment to the field to establish, manage and phase out HICs

Equipment – Equipment not included in country level cost plan templates. A fund designed to supplement IHP modules to ensure the HIC can experiment with new technology, fill gaps, and put the HIC on the cutting edge of humanitarian field technology. This budget line could also reside within OCHA ITS as reserved resources for HIC equipment.

Training – These costs will cover training and human resource development for staff inside OCHA and standby partner/roster systems to build specific skill sets among current and potential HIC staff.

Total annual cost for the HIC Management Cell is estimated to be:

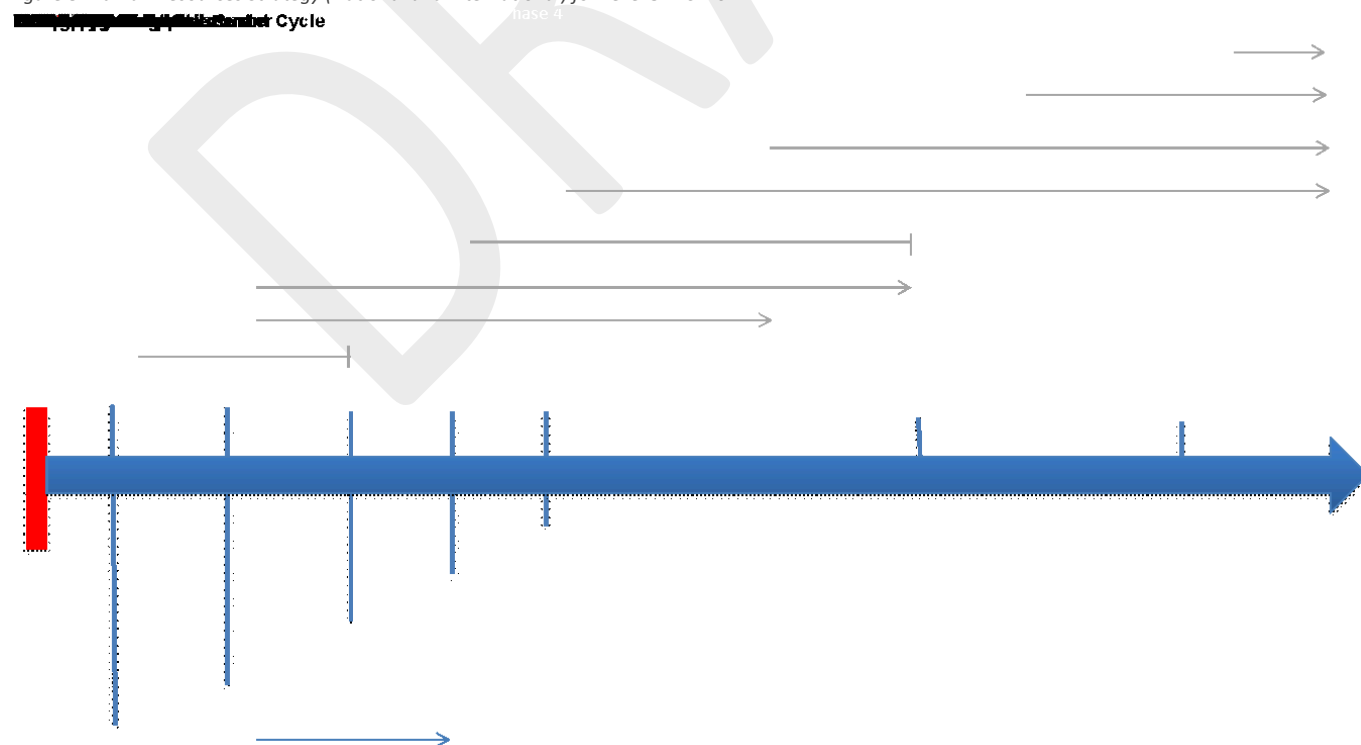
Total Staff Costs	538,852.00
Total non-staff costs	200,000.00
Sub-total	738,852.00
13% programme Support Costs	96,050.76
Total Project cost Plus Programme Support Costs	834,902.76

Human Resource Deployment and Staffing HIC 2.0 at the Field Level

As detailed in the deployment graphic, an ISS team would deploy with the UNDAC team and other staff drawn from ROs and the ERR. The team would consist of a HIC Manager and a mix of technical and support staff with staffing numbers depending on the size of the emergency and information coordination requirements. The ISS team would overlap with incoming staff from the ERR who would stay in place for up to three months. The ERR staff would hand over to staff recruited through the Standby Partner and ASP systems as they become available for longer term deployments. Administrative support for the HIC will come from a dedicated staff position, from the OCHA country office and/or from UNDP at the country level.

HIC 2.0 will employ and recruit national staff to complement the HIC 2.0 professional staff.

Figure 8: Human Resources Strategy (National and International) for Level 3 HIC 2.0



Systems to staff the HIC are in place, yet these systems must function seamlessly to ensure that the initial deployment team can hand over to a team of ASP and Standby Partners. As the ASP and SBP systems rely on secondments and the availability of free-lance consultants, HIC staffing challenges could arise.

HIC 2.0 Sample Organisational Charts

This section outlines three organisational charts that OCHA could use to staff levels 1-3 HICs. These organisational charts are instructive and OCHA can make amendments for each deployment context. Each size of HIC requires a certain level of staffing, equipment, and running costs. These varying levels of staff and equipment costs determine the amount and sophistication of products and services that the HIC can provide.

Level 3 HIC

The staffing functions for a Level 3 HIC are outlined below:

Central HIC Location

- **Manager and Senior Information Advisor (1 International)** – This crucial position manages all aspects of HIC deployment, operation and phase-down. The HIC manager provides leadership, vision, and strategic direction. The HIC manager and represents the HIC with external partners. In Level 3 emergencies, the HIC Manager acts as a strategic advisor to the Humanitarian Coordinator on data and information issues.
- **Deputy Manager for Operations (1 International)** – Supports the HIC Manager by running day to day HIC operations and directly managing international staff. The Deputy Manager for Ops designs the internal HIC data flows to optimise resources in support of HIC products and services.
- **Administration & Finance Capacity (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages the HIC's admin/finance functions within the country level budgets. This capacity could be placed within the OCHA office or within the HIC.
- **Drivers (Nationals)** – As needed depending on allocated vehicles.
- **Staffing Coordinator (1 International)** – Leads national and international staff recruitment and surge capacity management, and is phased out once key staff are in place.
- **Data coordination (1 International + 1 National)** – Leads the IM Network, and undertakes advocacy for open data. Focal point for Common Request Form (CRF) IM support in country.
- **Data management (1 International + 2 Nationals)** – Database management, document management, and technical support to clusters on database.
- **GIS and mapping (1 International + 2 Nationals)** – Produces analytical products and reference maps according to operational need.
- **Social Media Coordinator (1 International)** – Serves as the social media interface with the HIC, conducting analysis, pulling and pushing information as required.
- **Remote Community Focal Point (1 International)** – Acts as interface between the HIC and the global digital volunteers.
- **HumanitarianResponse.info (1 International + 1 National)** – Populates and manages the website.
- **Info Graphics and visuals (1 International + 1 National)** – Produces info graphics as a part of HIC products and services.
- **Coordination tools (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages OCHA's core coordination tools such as 3Ws, calendar and meeting schedule.
- **Cluster Support (1 International + 1 National)** – Coordinates and provides HIC 2.0 support to under resourced IASC Clusters to enhance their ability to participate in interagency information management systems.
- **Innovation Lab Manager (1 International)** – Manages innovation within the HIC, this professional has time allocated beyond HIC immediate tasks to experiment with new ideas, technology and processes to enhance field emergency information management.
- **Translation (2 nationals)** – Conduct translation services, potentially link to external volunteer translator groups.
- **Front office (4 nationals)** – Provide personal customer services to HIC users channelling requests to the appropriate HIC section.
- **Field liaison (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages Satellite HICs, and roves in the operational area gathering and disseminating information. Connects potential users to HIC services.
- **ICT Officer (3 International + 2 National)** – takes over ICT support from IHP, then scale down to a reduced presence over time.

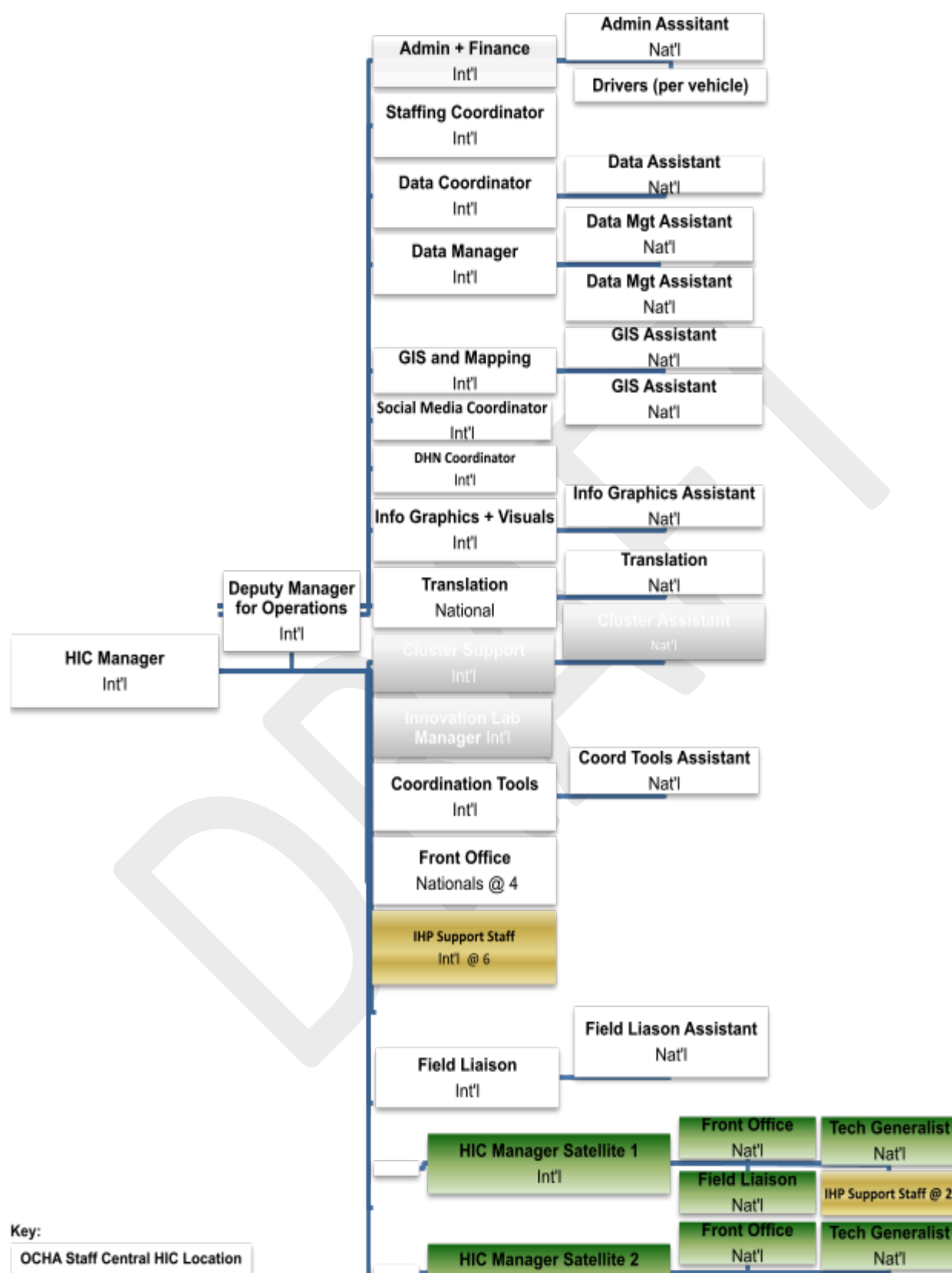
HIC Satellite Offices 3 for Level 3 HIC (Context Dependent)

- **Manager (1 International)** – Manages satellite HIC (combination of HIC Manager and Deputy Ops Manager descriptions above).
- **Front office (1 National)** – See above
- **Field liaison (1 International)** – See above
- **Tech Generalist (1 National)** – Fulfilling a wide range of information management tasks and sourcing tasks back to the central HIC

The graphic below describes reporting lines and relationship for a Level 3 HIC:

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Figure 9: Level 3 HIC in the field Org Chart



The Level 3 is the full service version of the HIC 2.0 concept. The HIC Manager and Deputy oversee a wide range of functions including basic information coordination products, more sophisticated analytical support, and additional

capacity to support specific IASC Clusters with information management expertise. Envisioned to Operating for a minimum of 12 months, the Level 3 HIC 2.0 is supported initially by international staffing and administrative coordinators, as well as a large team of locally recruited national staff to support HIC 2.0 products.

As shown in the diagram above, the Level 3 HIC 2.0 offers all core services such as coordinated assessment support, coordination tools, as well as the option of supporting new modules such as the Digital Humanitarian Network focal point, social network interaction and a common workspace designed to attract information professionals to collocate and collaborate.

Specific products will be based off of the 2008 HIC TORs, with specific analysis products created for the deployment context.

The total cost of a Level 3 HIC 2.0 (12 month duration) is projected to be:

Total Staff Costs	2,765,046.00
Total non-staff costs	458,700.00
Sub-total	3,223,746.00
13% programme Support Costs	419,086.98
Total Project cost Plus Programme Support Costs	3,642,832.98

Level 2 HIC 2.0 in the Field

A Level 2 HIC 2.0 on the field would contain the following functions:

- **Manager (1 International)** – This crucial position manages all aspects of HIC deployment, operation and phase-down. The HIC manager provides leadership, vision, and strategic direction. The HIC manager and represents the HIC with external partners.
- **Administration & Finance Capacity (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages the HIC's admin/finance functions within the country level budgets. This capacity could be placed within the OCHA office or within the HIC.
- **Drivers (Nationals)** – As needed depending on allocated vehicles.
- **Data coordination (1 International + 1 National)** – Leads the IM Network, and undertakes advocacy for open data. Focal point for Common Request Form (CRF) IM support in country.
- **Data management (1 International + 2 Nationals)** – Database management, document management, and technical support to clusters on database.
- **GIS and mapping (1 International + 2 Nationals)** – Produces analytical products and reference maps according to operational need.
- **Digital Humanitarian Network Focal Point (1 International)** – Acts as interface between the HIC and the global digital volunteers.
- **Info Graphics and visuals (1 International + 1 National)** – Produces info graphics as a part of HIC products and services.
- **Coordination tools (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages OCHA's core coordination tools such as 3Ws, calendar and meeting schedule.
- **Translation (2 nationals)** – Conduct translation services, potentially link to external volunteer translator groups.
- **Front office (4 nationals)** – Provide personal customer services to HIC users channelling requests to the appropriate HIC section.
- **Field liaison (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages Satellite HICs, and roves in the operational area gathering and disseminating information. Connects potential users to HIC services.

Figure 10: Level 2 HIC in the field Org Chart



The Level 2 HIC 2.0 provides a reduced number of products and services using the structure described above. With guidance from the HIC manager, a core team of 8 internationals provides core information management tools and services including assessment guidance, and basic analysis. An international administrative position supports the HIC scale-up in the early phases of the 6 month deployment timeframe.

Specific products will include the core coordination tools and services described in the Level 2 HIC 2.0 Graphic above, complemented by a basic analytical function in support of decision makers. The number of products and the sophistication of the products will be less than that provided by the full Level 3 HIC 2.0 system.

The total cost of a Level 2 HIC 2.0 (6 month deployment) is projected to be:

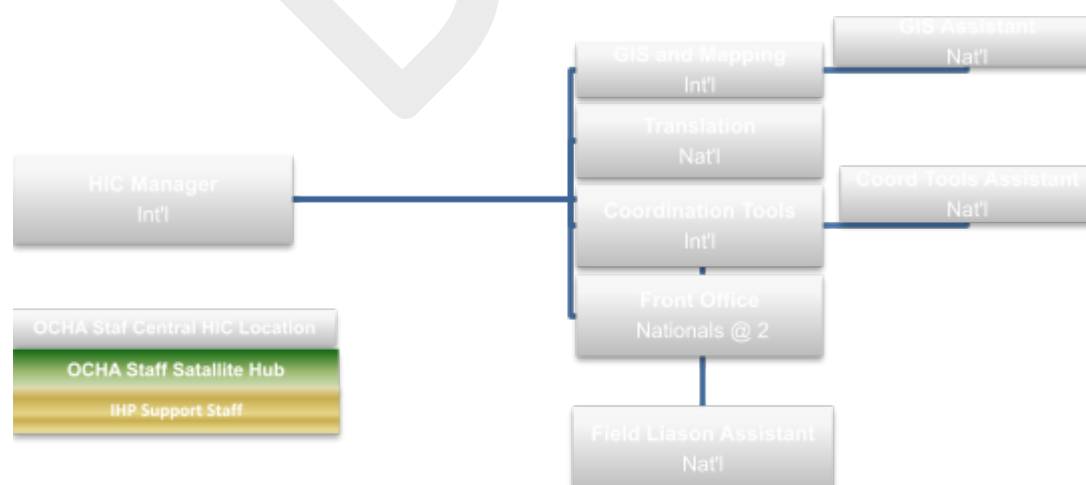
Total Staff Costs	612,456.00
Total non-staff costs	284,700.00
Sub-total	897,156.00
13% programme Support Costs	116,630.28
Total Project cost Plus Programme Support Costs	1,013,786.28

Level 1 HIC 2.0 at the Field Level

A HIC deployed in support of a Level 1 emergency will consist of the following team members:

- **Manager (1 International)** – This crucial position manages all aspects of HIC deployment, operation and phase-down. The HIC manager provides leadership, vision, and strategic direction. The HIC manager and represents the HIC with external partners. In this case, the HIC Manager will also undertake Data Coordination function including leading the IM Network, advocacy and CRF focal point.
- **GIS and mapping (1 International + 2 Nationals)** – Produces analytical products and reference maps according to operational need.
- **Coordination tools (1 International + 1 National)** – Manages OCHA's core coordination tools such as 3Ws, calendar and meeting schedule.
- **Translation (2 nationals)** – Conduct translation services, potentially link to external volunteer translator groups.
- **Front office (2 nationals)** – Provide personal customer services to HIC users channelling requests to the appropriate HIC section.
- **Field liaison (1 National)** – Manages Satellite HICs, and roves in the operational area gathering and disseminating information. Connects potential users to HIC services.

Figure 11: Level 1 HIC in the field Org Chart



Using the lightest footprint possible, this Level 1 HIC consists of a HIC Manager plus two additional international staff members supported by a small team of locally recruited national staff. The team provides a basic level of coordination and analysis support over the period of one month.

The team would focus on designing systems and building capacity for an immediate handover of information functions to an OCHA office or other suitable counterpart. The Level 1 HIC would have an advice, guidance and mentoring function, rather than a product delivery and analysis mechanism.

The total cost of a Level 1 HIC 2.0 (3 month deployment) is projected to be:

Total Staff Costs	140,489.00
Total non-staff costs	238,600.00
Sub-total	379,089.00
13% programme Support Costs	49,281.57
Total Project cost Plus Programme Support Costs	428,370.57

Engagement with OCHA Surge Capacity Mechanisms

HIC 2.0 will be largely staffed by partners and OCHA staff members through OCHA surge capacity mechanisms. Given this reality, the HIC Management Cell and ISS must engage closely with the Surge Capacity Section (SCS) to undertake a detailed planning process to ensure that surge capacity mechanisms are able to meet the additional demand that HIC 2.0 will add to existing capacity and deployments.

The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following steps in close collaboration with SCS for the Emergency Response Roster (ERR), Standby Partner Programme (SBPP) and Associates Surge Pool (ASP)

1. **Present the HIC 2.0 Concept** to SCS colleagues, provide materials, and develop a joint understanding of the overall staffing needs of HIC 2.0.
2. Develop and share **detailed HIC 2.0 Terms of Reference** for each of the profiles described in this document
3. Work closely with SCS to develop a current picture of **what capacity exists** within each surge mechanism (this includes ERR, ASP, and all 12 standby partners) that could be allocated to HIC 2.0. Develop a mechanism for consistently updated this picture every three months.
4. Develop and present SCS with **projected yearly HIC 2.0 staffing needs**.
5. Work together with SCS to develop a plan to **increase HIC 2.0 profiles within each surge mechanism** to ensure adequate support to HIC 2.0.
6. **Develop and implement HIC 2.0 trainings** to professionals within the SCS system to develop and maintain skill sets in support of the HIC 2.0 profiles.

Parallel to these efforts, the HIC management cell should develop and maintain a virtual roster of potential HIC candidates within the established surge mechanisms. This virtual roster could also include individuals outside of OCHA mechanism who could be encouraged to join the surge mechanisms in support of the HIC, or could alternatively be contracted through temporary vacancies.

Equipment and Logistics

The HIC 2.0 equipment systems include hardware and software elements that reflect the broad services offered to the humanitarian community, as well as the scalable, modular approach of the revised HIC concept.

International Humanitarian Partnership (IHP)

HIC 2.0 will primarily rely on equipment and staff support modules from the International Humanitarian Partnership (IHP). Upon a request from OCHA, the IHP can deploy any combination of equipment modules¹¹. Each equipment module comes with a proportional number of support staff required to set up, maintain it. The modules are *scalable*,

¹¹ OCHA ISB can initiate IHP request through OCHA's Field Coordination Support Section (SCSS), focal point Albrecht Beck (beck2@un.org)

mirroring the scalable nature of the revised HIC concept giving maximum flexibility to deploy small or large teams in one or multiple locations.

The IHP has the following HIC 2.0-relevant modules:

Personal ICT Equipment for support staff

These personal office modules are deployed with technical specialists from the providing country. Each Support Staff member carries this basic office equipment as hand luggage. This ensures minimum operability and capability to support the HIC in case of baggage loss.

OSOCC Module

This module provides a tented office and equipment for the setup and management of an On-Site Operations Coordination Centre (OSOCC) with up to 6-8 workstations. The module is designed for emergencies where there is no basic office support infrastructure and the team has to be completely self-sufficient. The IHP deploys this routinely in support of the UNDAC team, and could transition the equipment to a HIC.

ICT Module

The purpose of the ICT module is to provide information and communication technology to support a standard UNDAC or HIC team of 5-6 people operating worldwide where the basic accommodation infrastructure is intact. The module provides basic communications, internet access, and office services, to enable the team to collect, process and distribute timely information. Each ICT module can be divided into two separate modules to support separate locations, such as a small HIC and a reception/departure usually located at the airport. The module is accompanied by two IHP support staff that setup the equipment, ensure maintenance and provide general logistical and operational support.

Information Management Module

The IM module provides equipment and Operational Onsite Support Staff (OOSS) for the setup and management of an Information Management Cell in an OSOCC that could transition to an HIC. The module can be supplemented by the OSOCC module and/or the Light Base Camp/Base Camp Module. It is scalable and divided into three levels (large, medium and small) according to the scale of the disaster and resources that OCHA requests. The IM Module makes it possible to provide a wider range of information products by increasing printing and plotting capacity. The module can be accompanied by 2, 4, or 6 IHP support staff depending on the light/medium/heavy deployment package that OCHA requests.

Security Compliance Kit Supplementary Element

In emergencies where the security situation demands extra communication equipment, IHP will augment the ICT module with communication equipment for all IHP staff members. The module is adapted to the local UN security standard and is prepared on a case-by-case basis.

The following graphic provides a sample comparison of IHP modules and OCHA staffing (drawn from SBPs/rosters) levels. The current system is not specific on how many staff members could be supported with each module. The current agreement is flexible, and IHP appears to have a strong service mind-set towards the HIC concept, yet OCHA must work to further develop the operational details of this relationship.

Figure 12: IHP Modules and OCHA HIC 2.0 Staff

IHP Module	Purpose	Equipment	IHP Staff	Time to Deploy	Time in Field	Notes	OCHA Staff	Total HIC Team
Personal ICT + Staff Only	Ensures minimum operability, small scale connection and communication	Basic office equipment +BGAN	1 kit per person	24 Hours	3 week rotations for up to 6 months	Issued per team member,	n/a	n/a
OSOCC Module	Tented office for UNDAC (field office module)	Basic office equipment Wireless LAN, 8 Work Stations	2	24 Hours	3 week rotations for up to 6 months	Could transition to support 'HIC Small'	n/a for HIC	n/a
ICT Module	ICT for 5-6 member UNDAC or HIC team	Office equipment + supplies, server, basic printing, cameras, GPS, lighter than info Mgt module	2	24 Hours	3 week rotations timeline negotiable	Most used module usually for UNDAC. Basis for starting point	6	8
Information Management Module "HIC Large"	Equipment and Support Staff for Large IM Cell in an OSOCC or HIC. Transitions to HIC, Uses 2 ICT Modules.	Plotters, Printers, Work Stations + Print and Copy Capacity	6	24 Hours	3 week rotations timeline negotiable	4 to 6 staff providing 24 hour support	12	18
Information Management Module "HIC Medium"	Equipment and Support Staff for Medium IM Cell in an OSOCC or HIC	Printers, work stations (no plotter), GIS component via map action	4	24 Hours	3 week rotations timeline negotiable	Uses 2 ICT Modules	8	12
Information Management Module "HIC Small"	Equipment and Support Staff for Small IM Cell in an OSOCC or HIC	One printer, 3-4 work stations, Uses 1 ICT module with A3 printer,	2	24 Hours	3 week rotations timeline negotiable	Could accommodate up to 8 workstations	4	6
Security Compliance Kit	Extra comms for security	Radios/Programming Software, GPS	1 kit per person	24 Hours	3 week rotations timeline negotiable	Kit to OCHA team members?	n/a	n/a
IHP Base Camp	Full catering, accommodation and hygiene support	Full accommodation for HIC team and others		72 Hours	6 week rotations, timeline negotiable	Specific workspace for HIC,	n/a	n/a
IHP Light Base Camp	Catering, accommodation,	light accommodation, can had cary		24 Hours		Could provide accommodation for HIC team of 5 members	n/a	n/a

Standardized Equipment Lists

Standardized equipment lists exist within the IHP materials. Based on interviews with selected team members and OCHA liaison staff, the system was found to be appropriate for anticipated needs and available now for deployment. Please see Annex 1 for a complete list of IHP Modules.

Other Support Modalities

Additional human resources or equipment would have to be provided by the cost plan of an OCHA office within the country. Additional funding might be available on an *ad hoc* basis from OCHA ISS, but the long term funding for HICs

and additional equipment not included in the IHP package must come from the country level cost plan. All equipment remains as IHP member property and must be returned to the sending agency at the end of a HIC deployment however OCHA must continue to define these operational details as a part of the HIC 2.0 design process.

ICT Support

Dedicated ICT staff accompany each equipment module throughout the deployment. Extended deployments would have to be approved by the IHP donor nation supplying the staff and equipment, but a deployment of up to 6 months is feasible. In deployments exceeding 6 months, OCHA ICT capacity would support the IHP-provided equipment. These staff would be funded through the OCHA office within the country of deployment.

HIC 2.0 Design Tasks for Equipment

The current modules are adequate for a HIC 2.0 deployment but require the following additions to be implemented as a part of the HIC 2.0 design process:

1. Develop a clear message on what HIC 2.0 equipment support, with **specific responsibilities for both IHP and OCHA focal points**.
2. Ensure that **IHP has provided written confirmation on the availability and support to HIC 2.0** equipment needs.
3. Continue to **review the HIC 2.0 equipment requirements** and update accordingly.
4. Define and request that IHP include HIC 2.0 specific material in the IM modules such as branding material, white boards, specialised stationary and office equipment. This material would be similar to the OSOCC package (OSOCC flags etc.) but would be HIC specific.
5. Elucidate **detailed deployment sequences to differentiate HIC modules and processes** from OSOCC/UNDAC modules and processes. OCHA and IHP need to ensure that there is a strong differentiation between the two sets of modules, and that there is consistent availability for two separate Level 3 emergency deployments of both UNDAC and HIC modules.
6. Continue to **develop and implement IHP Operation Onsite Support Staff (OOSS) training program** in collaboration with FCSS colleagues to train IHP staff on HIC 2.0 processes.
7. Develop a nuanced understanding of the general IHP support table above to **harmonize IHP and OCHA staffing at various levels**. This will be a multi-step process in coordination with OCHA's Field Capacity Support Section (FCSS) focal points who manage the OCHA-IHP relationship.

Role of OCHA ICT in the HIC

OCHA Information and Communications Technology (ITS) Section will provide support to HIC 2.0 by i) being available to equip a HIC 2.0 if IHP is unable for any reason to provide these services, and ii) providing ITC services to IHP equipment when IHP ends its staff support, and iii) providing complete IT equipment and support if a HIC is physically co-located within an existing OCHA office. Given IHP's unofficial maximum deployment timeframe of 6 months, OCHA ICT may need to provide ICT support to HIC 2.0 systems for an additional 6 month period. In addition, OCHA ICT could manage the selection and procurement of *ad hoc* equipment request for HIC 2.0.

OCHA is engaging IHP in discussions to gain commitment about specific IHP support to the HIC 2.0 concept. In the meantime, OCHA ISS should work with OCHA ICT as a contingency to the IHP system. This process should include the following items:

1. A detailed message on the **type of support that OCHA ICT might provide to HIC 2.0**.
2. Agreement on **equipment lists** that OCHA ICT might need to supply to the HIC 2.0.
3. A shared understanding of the **activation and deployment process** for OCHA ICT equipment and staffing support to a HIC 2.0.

HIC 2.0 Products and Services

As outlined earlier, the HIC 2.0 will take a modular approach to providing products and services in relation to the scale and nature of the humanitarian response. For the purpose of this paper the term "module" refers to a distinct configuration of staff and/or activities that are designed to provide a particular service or address an information need. HIC 2.0 consists of essential functions or 'Core Modules' making up the 'nucleus' of its work and are present in every

deployment. Surrounding these core modules are 'Additional Modules' that can be added to the Core Modules in a surrounding 'electron cloud' as required by the deployment context.

Each module is described below using the following template:

Definition and Approach – What is the definition of the module? How will the module operate?

Justification – Why build and deploy this module? (For elements not included in previous HIC deployments.)

Key Components – What elements make up the module? This can be a combination of people, equipment, and guidance.

Module Outputs – What will this module produce?

Current Status – Is the module ready to deploy? Readiness is assessed as green (ready to deploy), yellow (ready to deploy with some additional development) or red (not ready to deploy).

Build process – What should the HIC Management Cell undertake to build and deploy this module?

Core Modules

The HIC 2.0 Core Modules represent the basic functions required to establish an understanding of humanitarian need, to identify the actors are present in the operating environment and institute a system for basic information coordination among these actors. The HIC 2.0 core modules include a suite of analytical functions used develop and deliver these products and services.



Mapping/Geographic Information System (GIS)/Remote Sensing

Definition and Approach – The Mapping, GIS, and Remote Sensing Module conducts spatial analysis, and in rare circumstances builds reference maps. Previous HIC deployments had a large mapping component that often focused on providing reference maps while only occasionally undertaking GIS analysis. Given the wide availability and accessibility of online mapping systems such as Google Earth and Open Street Map, HIC 2.0 will shift the focus away from reference mapping to a stronger emphasis on supporting analysis. The GIS approach should link other HIC 2.0 elements such as mapping instances of damage reports in social media, providing detailed damage assessment summaries, and mapping humanitarian need against service delivery. In addition, the use of information graphic solutions will be promoted to better promote situational understanding through maps.

Key Components – One or more GIS experts with understanding of the humanitarian context; GIS software; computers; plotters, paper and ink.

Module Outputs – A wider variety of analytical products that directly support the critical stages within the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

Current Status – Green: This element is ready to deploy based on existing OCHA GIS capacity and a strong track record in previous HICs.

Build process –

- ✓ Verify numbers of OCHA GIS staff and standby partner capacity.
- ✓ Review this capacity against deployment projections.
- ✓ Develop new terms of reference that emphasis complex analysis over reference map production.



Database¹²

Definition and Approach – Database construction and maintenance is essential build the foundation with which much of the analysis of the HIC is carried out and supports almost all other HIC 2.0 Modules. In addition to internal data

¹² Graphic: Ed Jones, from The Noun Project

development work, the HIC may be required to develop and maintain database systems in support of under resourced Cluster partners, and in support of inter-agency assessment systems. This support will emphasize interoperability and exchange standards that lead to systems integration and the open exchange of data. The database team will also manage HIC 2.0's use of existing database systems.

Key Components – Database experts with understanding of the humanitarian context, computers, modules, database software.

Module Outputs – A range of database design and management services in support of the Humanitarian Programme Cycle

Current Status – Green: This element is ready to deploy based on existing OCHA GIS capacity and a previous database management in HIC and IMU structure.

Build process –

- ✓ Verify numbers of OCHA database staff and standby partner capacity.
- ✓ Review this capacity against deployment projections.
- ✓ Develop new terms of reference that emphasis complex analysis over reference map production.



Who Does What, Where (3W), Contact List, Meeting Schedule¹³

Definition and Approach – The 3W, Contact List and Meeting Schedule support basic information coordination in emergencies. They provide basic awareness of on-going programming to avoid duplication, and help humanitarian actors connect with each other and attend coordination meetings. The tools are most useful when the humanitarian community buys-in and keeps the information they contain current.

Key Components – 3Ws, Contact List and Meeting Schedule Templates (and forthcoming tools now under development)

Module Outputs – Documents, info graphics, calendars and spreadsheets showing on-going humanitarian action, contact lists, and meeting schedules.

Current Status – Yellow: The HIC Status Review found that offline/manual 3Ws, meeting schedule, and contact list exist in Word and Excel versions and could be deployed by the HIC. While these tools function at a basic level, a Level 3 deployment scenario would overload these tools. This remains a gap area, and OCHA ISS is reviewing and updating the functionality of these tools to increase their speed and utility in Level 3 emergencies.

Build process – OCHA ISS will update these products in 2013.

¹³ Graphic: Johan H. W. Basbert, from The Noun Project

HR Website

Definition and Approach – In a new emergency, the HIC will populate and manage the country-specific www.humanitarianresponse.info site, the website that has been developed to share operational and cluster-related information among humanitarian partners at the field level. When deployed in an ongoing emergency, the HIC would support any existing in-country website (and support for this functioning website) through an OCHA IMU.

Key Components – Field-level web experts, or information generalists using remote support from OCHA ISS.

Module Outputs – The Website Module will produce a populated and updated Humanitarianresponse.info website.

Current Status – Green: This system is under development, but is available for immediate deployment.

Build process –

- ✓ Verify OCHA web development staff and standby partner capacity.
- ✓ Review this capacity against deployment projections.
- ✓ Develop new terms of reference to reflect the needs of HIC 2.0.

HK HKiosk

Definition and Approach – The Humanitarian Kiosk (HKiosk) application provides a range of up-to-the-minute humanitarian related information from emergencies around the world. The application has multiple independent kiosks which reflect locations where OCHA operates or there is an on-going international humanitarian emergency. The HIC would populate and manage the content of the HKiosk application. Future iterations of the HKiosk will support interaction with users collecting contact information and carrying out user surveys.

Justification – When deployed, the HIC would own the HKiosk as the virtual arm of a physical Humanitarian Kiosk, a public area where users can browse hard copy information materials, or access electronic versions. The HKiosk app delivers similar content directly to tablet and phone devices¹⁴. This increases delivery speed and provides the information in a mobile friendly format.

Key Components – A Dropbox link for the specific emergency created by ISS provides the back-end system to the HKiosk system. This simple file sharing format allows a technical or generalist focal point to manage content in the Dropbox file by saving or deleting content in a cloud file system synced to their personal computer.

Module Outputs – Rapid information dissemination to handheld devices.

Current Status – Green: Already in use, ready for use within a HIC.

Build process – No build process required.



Needs Assessment Module

Definition and Approach – The Assessment Support Module provides information management expertise to assessments within the Program Cycle. This includes the Multi-Cluster Initial Rapid Needs Assessment (MIRA) and detailed cluster assessments in support of the Flash Appeal and Cap Cycle.

¹⁴ <http://kiosk.humanitarianresponse.info/>

Justification – The IASC has made significant strides in coordinating rapid needs assessment to develop a common understanding of humanitarian need in emergencies. This is encapsulated in the MIRA process. This common assessment approach provides the foundation for needs-based strategic planning and monitoring mechanisms. Information management is an essential part of all MIRA phases and the HIC would be the focal point for technical support.

Key Components – The module consists of information professionals with knowledge of humanitarian assessment methodology and the information systems that support this methodology.

Module Outputs – This role would include the following:

- Hosting the assessment registry on www.humanitarianresponse.info;
- Carrying out secondary data analysis;
- Supporting Preliminary Scenario Definition (PSD);
- Survey sampling methodology;
- Data collection platform : KoBo Project (mobile data collection platform) and related questionnaire development and database support;
- Analysis of survey findings by linking new primary data to baseline common operational datasets.
- Linking the on-going assessment process to the monitoring and evaluation elements of the humanitarian program cycle.

Current Status – Yellow: While a HIC could support a MIRA or individual Cluster assessment process, standardised database systems do not exist to support the MIRA, and would have to be constructed on an ad hoc basis. Information management experts with knowledge of needs assessment methodologies are scarce.

Build process –

- ✓ Create a detailed schematic of information management support to the Humanitarian Program Cycle, including the specific support for the needs assessment component.
- ✓ In collaboration with OCHA's Coordinated Assessment Support Section (CASS), develop database templates for the MIRA based on previous examples from the field.



Analysis and Decision Support Module

Definition and Approach – The HIC 2.0 concept prioritizes strategic decision making support by emphasizing predictable and systematic analytical products for the humanitarian community. When first deployed, the HIC will establish basic coordination systems through its Core Modules. As the deployment progresses, the HIC will look to develop increasingly sophisticated analytical products according to the needs defined by the Humanitarian Coordinator and Humanitarian Country Team in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

Justification – Past HIC evaluations have highlighted the debate between the HIC providing basic coordination products like planning maps or contact lists versus developing more sophisticated planning tools for complex decision support. This debate will persist in future deployments and is a potential risk for OCHA. OCHA should mitigate this risk by developing internal consensus, then providing a clear external message through the HIC manager on what products and services the HIC should deliver.

Key Components – The HIC Manager should lead the production of a predictable set of analytical products on an agreed timeline using all elements of the humanitarian coordination system.

Module Outputs – Examples of analytical products that the HIC may produce include:

- Visualisations of interagency assessment findings.
- Analysis of assessment findings against secondary and baseline data showing humanitarian need.
- GIS analysis of conditions in areas of return overlaid with the number of displaced people wishing to return to these areas.

These example products should combine to provide analysis to support strategic planning and decision making about gaps in the response system, and the consequences of non-delivery, rather than reporting on what aid has been delivered.

Current Status – Yellow: HIC 2.0 is committed to providing analysis for decision support, yet there is no specific method for accomplishing this goal in a sudden onset or protracted emergency.

Build process – The HIC Management Cell should work closely with the internal OCHA Data Working Group established in September 2012 to align the Analysis and Decision Support Module to evolving system-wide humanitarian leadership and coordination. This module will develop over time, but should remain at the centre of the HIC 2.0 approach to supporting humanitarian response. This development process should also include a training component to help HIC staff differentiate and prioritize analytical over reference materials. The training material should support similar messaging to the HC candidate pool and accompanying training systems via OCHA's HC Support Unit to ensure that HCs also prioritize strategic analytical material at the field level.



IM Network Module

Definition and Approach – This country-level working group provides a forum for establishing data exchange standards, advocating for open data among organizations and creating a community of practice for IM professionals engaged in the response operation.

Justification – Established under the IASC *Operational Guidance* on information management.

Key Components – Staff to manage the network and buy-in from participants who see added value in network services.

Module Outputs – Commonly-agreed data exchange standards and Core Data Sets.

Current Status – Green: The IM network has been successfully deployed over the past ten years and will continue to be used in all HIC deployments.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 concept will seek to expand the network into an actual co-working space where members can meet and collaborate on information initiatives.



HIC 2.0 Reach-Back Support

Reach-back virtual support for the HIC, connecting issues on the ground with internal OCHA resources (IMO Network and other capacity within the organisation)

Definition and Approach – The HIC 2.0 Reach Back Support module connects demand for information support and analysis to spare capacity within OCHA. The module uses a similar approach to the DHN, where a focal point collects tasks from the response context at the field level, understands the need, translates this need to spare capacity within the organisation and delivers the final product to the requesting entity.

Justification – This module embodies the networked approach of HIC 2.0, where physical presence on the ground links information needs to a global network of capabilities.

Key Components – National and international staff, with connectivity and computing equipment.

Module Outputs – A more efficient use of available resources within OCHA, and a wide range of remotely supported products.

Current Status – Yellow: The concept exists within the OCHA IM Skype Group where practitioners discuss issues and support each other. However, the HIC 2.0 Management Cell needs to elaborate and regularise the process in emergencies.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ **Study** the IM Skype group as a model for this function.
- ✓ **Elaborate a detailed concept note** with clear responsibilities for the network members and focal point. Consider using the Emergency Response Roster as a model, where staff apply and are obligated to participate in provide capacity to HIC 2.0 for a defined period of time.
- ✓ **Finalise and deploy** the module.

Additional Modules

This section describes the additional modules that OCHA can add to HIC 2.0. In a Level 3 emergency, it is possible that all of the modules described below would be deployed at various phases of the response.



Translation Module

Definition and Approach – The Translation Module provides rapid translation between official UN languages and other languages in the area of deployment.

Justification – Adequate translation support is frequently cited as a perennial problem in humanitarian response operations.

Key Components – The Translation Module will consist of national staff hired to conduct on-site written and verbal translation, as well as a ‘reach-back’ component that links translation needs in the emergency to an international network of volunteer translators such as Translators Without Borders, or similar organisation¹⁵.

Module Outputs – the Translation Module will produce rapid written and verbal translation services between official UN languages and other languages in the area of deployment.

Current Status – Yellow: The HIC could hire local experts to undertake translation, but the ‘reach-back’ function does not exist.

Build Process –

- ✓ Define the structure of a HIC 2.0 Translation Module including needs, outputs and management structure.
- ✓ Liaise with potential translation networks and encourage their admission to the Digital Humanitarian Network (DHN).
- ✓ Build the remote support for the Translation Module around the DHN systems and approach.



Digital Humanitarian Network Module (DHN)

Definition and Approach – The Digital Humanitarian Network (DHN) Module connects information tasks within an emergency to a network-of-networks consortium of volunteer and technical communities to provide an interface between traditional humanitarian response entities and the evolving communities¹⁶. The module provides remote volunteer support to humanitarian responders through a designated interface.

¹⁵ <http://translatorswithoutborders.org>

¹⁶ <http://digitalhumanitarians.com/>

Key Components – This module consists of one or more professional staff who collect information management tasks from the field, communicate the tasks to the DHN, and manage the production and delivery of these products to the requesting entity within the HIC or within the wider humanitarian response community.

Module Outputs – Specific outputs may vary, but the approach will follow a micro-tasking approach where a large group of volunteers pools their time around a single task to create, process and analyse data.

Current Status – Yellow: The DHN exists and has provided assistance to humanitarian action in the field but a consistent institutional link has not yet been established.

Build Process –

- ✓ Engage DHN and ISS focal points in a **dialogue on the specifics of the DHN Module**.
- ✓ In collaboration with the DHN, identify a **defined set of tasks** that would comprise the DHN Module service catalogue.
- ✓ Develop a specific **terms of reference** for the DHN focal point.
- ✓ Explore the possibility of **inviting a member of the DHN** to assist in implementing the DHN Module at the field level.
- ✓ Develop this profile and **identify potential OCHA staff and standby partner members for this position**.



Communication with Disaster Affected Communities (CDACs)¹⁷

Definition and Approach – The CDACs module adopts the approach of the CDACs network, The CDAC network putting two-way communication with disaster affected communities at the heart of a humanitarian response operation.¹⁸ The function of this module is to either align HIC 2.0 products, messages and services to a CDAC network focal point outside of HIC 2.0, or to develop CDACs systems within HIC 2.0 if no other focal point is present.

Justification – Although this is clearly a communications issue, information is at the heart of this communication strategy, and thus HIC 2.0 includes this module.

Key Components – This module consists of professional staff employing a strategy built around the CDACs approach that treats information as an essential commodity in an emergency response environment. Staff for this module should be seconded to the HIC from a CDAC network member.

Module Outputs – Outputs could include info graphics (in collaboration with the Info Graphics Module) as well as two way communication with disaster affected communities through mobile technology, online and traditional media outlets, and face to face communication.

Current Status – Yellow: The CDACs methodology and network exists, but the HIC 2.0 Management Cell must develop the module.

Build Process – The HIC Management Cell should undertake the following:

1. Develop a **concept note** on the CDACs approach within HIC 2.0 and share with the OCHA CDACs focal point¹⁹.
2. Elaborate a **deployment process and specific terms of reference and required staff** for the module.
3. Match this profile **to candidates within OCHA and standby partner systems**.
4. **Build and deploy** the CDACs module.

¹⁷ Graphic Dima Yagnyuk, from The Noun Project

¹⁸ <http://www.cdacnetwork.org/>

¹⁹ Current focal point within OCHA is Imogen Wall, email address wall@un.org



Social Media Module²⁰

Definition and Approach – The purpose of the Social Media Module is to create a two way flow of useful information between social media platforms and humanitarian actors responding to an emergency in the field. The module will identify clear areas where social media information can be collected, processed, analysed and transformed into actionable information. The module will also push information from the humanitarian sector onto social networks in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

Justification – Social media is in vogue, but the work of this module must create real value for the emergency response. This module will assist with the process of developing useful applications for this powerful medium.

Key Components – Professional staff tasked with managing HIC 2.0's use of social media who have knowledge of the use of social media in humanitarian contexts. The module also includes basic computing and mobile equipment.

Module Outputs – Data from social media sources to be incorporated into humanitarian information analysis, and an online presence that pushes key messages onto social media platforms in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

Current Status – Red: All elements to be built.

Build Process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

1. Continue to **elaborate the Social Media Module concept**.
2. Elaborate a **catalogue of functions and services** that the module would provide
3. Develop **terms of reference** for the staff position.
4. Identify **potential secondment opportunities** from the global technology community to fulfil this role.
5. **Identify OCHA and standby partner capacity** to fill this role if a secondment from the global technology community is not possible.



Graphic Design Module²¹

Definition and Approach – The module will create and update data graphics for HIC projects, and depending on the emergency, may assist clusters in information visualisation.

Justification – The visual display of quantitative information is an effective tool for the analytical and decision support functions of HIC 2.0.

Key Components – The module consists of national and international staff, visualisation software, computers/monitors and printing capacity.

Module Outputs – Data graphics in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

Current Status – Yellow: OCHA has capacity to produce data graphics, but professionals with these skills may not be available to deploy.

Build Process –

- ✓ Verify numbers of OCHA data visualisation experts and standby partner capacity
- ✓ Review this capacity against deployment projections

²⁰ Joris Hoogendoorn, from The Noun Project

²¹ Anna Weiss, from The Noun Project

- ✓ Develop new terms of reference that emphasis complex analysis as a central feature of this



Common Workspace Module

Definition and Approach – The common workspace module is a collaboration space that will form the heart of information collaboration within HIC 2.0. The space is designed as a magnet to pull information managers into a common workspace, with their proximity leading to greater coordination and collaboration. This is a physical workspace with a conducive work environment catering to information managers and strategic decision makers within humanitarian organisations. It is an informal meeting point for work and an informal interaction.

Justification – The Common Workspace module mirrors the recent development of co-working spaces in urban centres across the world where independent professionals, writers and designers interact in a creative and collaborative environment. This interaction increases the connectivity and productivity of participants and may produce greater information collaboration in an emergency response setting. The co-working space is modelled on the idea of a technology cluster, where geography and labour availability lead to business co-location. This proximity builds an ecosystem of innovation and development where talent and ideas move freely between organisations. Likewise, the HIC 2.0 Co Working Module attempts to use proximity and collaboration to improve the quality of humanitarian information management.

Key Components – The physical elements of the Common Workspace module include comfortable chairs, shared work tables, quiet pods for phone calls, a common meeting space, a charging station, internet access, as well as food and drink. The workspace may also include secretarial services, laundry, printing and copying, and a weekly BBQ and movie night. Connectivity for the common workspace should be provided by the Emergency Telecoms Cluster (ETC).

Module Outputs – This module produces a common workspace for meeting and collaboration, and a pull factor bringing together the information management community. The by-product of this co-location will be enhanced relationships and increased information coordination.

Current Status – Red: HIC 2.0 Management Cell to build.

Build Process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following actions:

- ✓ **Continue collaborating** with common workspace experts²².
- ✓ **Build support for the module** within OCHA.
- ✓ Work with IHP focal points to **develop equipment lists** for the common workspace. IHP is likely to procure these materials locally in each HIC deployment.
- ✓ **Build and deploy** the concept.



Coffee Module²³

Definition and Approach – The Coffee Module is an integral part of the Common Workspace Module, supplying the best java in the emergency free of charge to information management colleagues to increase interaction and information coordination.

²² Mark Slezak initiated discussions with Bucketworks and Willow Brugh, via Andrej Verity. Continue these interactions as the module develops.

²³

Justification – The best coffee in the region will create a magnet effect and when combined with Wi-Fi and the common workspace, will provide an incentive for information management staff to meet, share data, and collaborate. This concept is modelled on the ‘Beer for Data’ program that successfully aggregated data sets in Afghanistan.

Key Components – Packet based espresso machine (Nespresso or similar brand) and HIC 2.0 branded coffee cups.

Module Outputs – The Coffee Module will produce the best coffee in the area.

Current Status – Red: HIC 2.0 Management Cell to build.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ **Build support** for this *apparently* unorthodox concept around the common workspace module
- ✓ Compile a **detailed list** of equipment and supplies.
- ✓ **Gain commitment** from OCHA ITS and IHP to provide the module alongside other equipment modules.



Government Liaison Module²⁴

Definition and Approach – Close liaison with the host government is essential to building sustainable information coordination mechanisms. Adding a distinct module emphasising the role of government liaison will institutionalise this approach within HIC.

Justification – Host governments in humanitarian response scenarios fall on a wide spectrum of both interest and capacity to engage with the humanitarian community. When the host government has a strong interest in close coordination and involvement with the response, the Government Liaison module can provide an interface on information issues. When the government is not able or motivated to engage, the module can encourage collaboration and build capacity with information counterparts.

Key Components – Staff to manage the relationships and liaison activities and, where appropriate, desk space for government counterparts to co-locate in the HIC workspace.

Module Outputs – Enhanced coordination and information sharing with government counterparts, and increased government capacity information management.

Current Status – Red: HIC 2.0 Management cell to build and deliver.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ **Further elaborate** the Government Liaison Module
- ✓ Develop **terms of reference** (for dedicated staff member or for inclusion as secondary role)
- ✓ **Build and deploy** the module



Private Sector Liaison Module

Definition and Approach – In collaboration with the Early Recovery Cluster, the Private Sector Liaison Module seeks to bolster response and recovery efforts through collaboration with national and international private sector entities wishing to participate and support response and recovery efforts.

²⁴ Graphic Sergi Delgado, from The Noun Project

Justification – HIC 2.0 will have a specific module to channel the increasing interest in national and global corporate social responsibility. Local businesses often assist in aid efforts, and this module provides an entry point for collaboration on information issues. Local businesses often have information, local knowledge, networks and logistics systems in place that could be adapted to support information management and aid delivery mechanisms.

Key Components – Staff to manage relationships, and workspace to accommodate secondments from national and global companies seeking collaboration with humanitarian information management systems.

Module Outputs – The module would enhance information sharing and collaboration with private sector entities.

Current Status – Red: Currently in the conceptual phase.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ **Further elaborate** the Private Sector Liaison Module
- ✓ **Develop terms of reference** (for dedicated staff member or for inclusion as secondary role)
- ✓ **Build and deploy** the module



HIC 2.0 Innovation Labs

Definition and Approach – The HIC 2.0 Innovation Lab is a physical and virtual space where team members and the wider humanitarian community can experiment with new ideas and technology to improve the quality of humanitarian response operations. The innovation lab should focus on both process innovation (improving processes in humanitarian management systems) and product innovation (bringing new products and tools to bear on humanitarian information dilemmas).

Justification – Innovation often takes pace incrementally through experimentation, collaboration and intermingling of ideas and concepts. The module provides physical space, allocated time, and equipment to support this process, but more importantly institutionalises this concept in the information manager's mind-set.

Key Components – Physical space, staff with allocated time for innovation, web platforms, examples of new technology, and an open mind.

Module Outputs – Investing in innovation will lead to better approaches for information management and humanitarian response in the field.

Specific areas to explore in the HIC 2.0 Innovation Lab may include:

Cash Coordination– The delivery and use of cash assistance is gaining acceptance. It is likely that this will play a major role in future response operations, and possibly supersede traditional assistance vectors. How will this assistance be coordinated, tracked and managed? Where are the points of innovation and excellence in today's cash response environment?

Drones – The use of Unmanned Aerial Vehicles (UAVs) is gaining momentum beyond military applications. The United Nations used drones to conduct remote sensing activities in the 2010 Haiti earthquake response, and their use is likely to increase in a variety of emergency program support roles. How can HIC 2.0 engage this new technology to increase our understanding of the response environment? How should the use of this technology be harnessed and coordinated?

3D Printing – Three dimensional printers are falling in price and becoming attainable for consumers and may soon play a role in humanitarian response environments. The technology creates three dimensional objects based on technical diagrams by combining successive layers of material. Aside from the obvious impact on decentralised manufacturing, this concept could support aid efforts by allowing practitioners and even affected communities to produce the relief

items they require. More practically, the HIC could use 3D printing to create geographic modelling of to create sophisticated maps for responders. What are the specific applications of 3D printing that are relevant in today's environment? What are the applications for the future?

Current Status – Red: Although OCHA is beginning to recognize the importance of innovation (see ReliefWeb Labs concept) the organisation has yet to resource and institutionalise an innovative approach.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following:

- ✓ Continue to **elaborate the HIC 2.0 Innovation Lab concept**.
- ✓ **Link the concept to the ReliefWeb Innovation Lab** to build a coalition for innovation within the organisation.
- ✓ Create a **fund for innovation** within the HIC 2.0 Management Cell to resource specific products.
- ✓ Explore the possibility of **seconding or allocating core staff to the Innovation Module** in upcoming HIC 2.0 deployments.



Meteorological Module²⁵

Definition and Approach – The Meteorological Model provides remote sensing support on weather related issues to the humanitarian community through the HIC structure.

Justification – A subset of remote sensing, this module could add another layer of analysis around climatic conditions in emergencies. Weather conditions are a key element in determining the type of shelter, nutrition and hygiene services needed in an emergency. The analysis is often conducted at a basic level, and this module could provide additional sophistication to the process.

Key Components – A focal point from the World Meteorological Organization or relevant organisation present in the HIC, or providing support through the DHN focal point.

Module Outputs – Weather predictions linked to status of roads based on rainfall, terrain, and soils. The module could provide projects on human survivability based on wind, temperature and humidity.

Current Status – Red: Conceptual phase.

Build process – HIC 2.0 Management Cell to explore the concept²⁶.



Cluster Information Support Module

Definition and Approach – The Cluster Information Support Module provides information management expertise to clusters with weak information management capacity.

Justification – IASC Clusters have varying levels of information management support at the field level. Recent disasters and evaluations²⁷, have shown that Clusters are not providing adequate information management support at the field level. OCHA's inter-cluster information management role requires good quality data from Clusters to develop analysis and decision support products. OCHA must provide a basic level of information support to under resources clusters to fulfil its mandate. This support will not absolve Clusters of their responsibilities around information management, and

²⁵ Graphic Alex Sheyn, from The Noun Project

²⁶ Discussions initiated by CJ Hendrix (hendrix@un.org) in December 2012 with Steve Foreman (sforeman@wmo.int).

²⁷ <http://www.urd.org/Real-time-evaluation-in-Haiti,458> , paragraph 134

will not institutionalise this type of support to Clusters. Rather, this module is recognition that basic information capacity within each cluster is a prerequisite to OCHA (and HIC 2.0's) success.

Key Components – National and International staff to provide support to Clusters.

Module Outputs – Advice on information collection, collation, processing and dissemination systems within individual clusters. The module will provide guidance on how to link intra-Cluster information systems to OCHA's inter-Cluster coordination systems.

Current Status – Red: Although the raw material and expertise exists within OCHA to deploy these services, additional discussion is required to validate the concept within OCHA and undertake messaging with the humanitarian community.

Build process – The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should use the following approach:

1. Further consider and elaborate the concept.
2. Undertake informal consultation within OCHA on this service.
3. Informally pilot the concept in upcoming HIC 2.0 deployments.

HIC 2.0 Module Summary

The HIC Management Cell should undertake the following actions to build and maintain the HIC 2.0 Core and Additional Modules:

1. Provide a **summary assessment of each module** to gain a clear picture of the current status of each element.
2. Define **human and financial requirements** to build and maintain each module
3. **Compare the human and financial requirements** against existing surge capacity systems and budgets.
4. **Secure the financial and surge capacity requirements** to build and deploy the modules
5. Develop and implement **project plans to build and maintain** these modules.

Guidance

HIC 2.0 relies on a new interpretation of existing policy and administrative guidance systems. These directives come from the IASC, or originate from OCHA's internal structures. As OCHA rolls out HIC 2.0, it may become necessary to amend some or all of these guidance documents as the operating environment and the HIC 2.0 systems develop.

Policy Guidance

Operational Guidance Note on Information Management – The IASC approved operational guidance on Responsibilities of Cluster/Sector Leads & OCHA in Information Management provides the foundation for HIC 2.0's work and interaction with IASC Clusters²⁸. This guidance is still valid, and HIC 2.0 will operate within this guidance. Although not mentioned by name in the document, the HIC has, and will carry out OCHA's field level responsibilities for inter-Cluster coordination.

HIC Terms of Reference – The Terms of Reference for Humanitarian Information Centres provides IASC validation for the HIC context. These terms of reference are still in effect, and the revised HIC 2.0 concept interprets these TORs in the context of the Transformative Agenda

Transformative Agenda – The IASC Transformative Agenda is a set of actions designed to improve the way the humanitarian community responds to emergencies. In December 2011, as part of discussions around the IASC Transformative Agenda, the IASC Principals adopted 46 action points to strengthen humanitarian action. Action point 22 recognises the need for improved information management and asked OCHA to consider the reestablishment of common Humanitarian Information Centres (HICs) at country level. The Transformative Agenda places the Humanitarian Program Cycle at the centre of planning processes. HIC 2.0 will therefore support information management within the Humanitarian Program cycle at the field level.

²⁸ Operational Guidance on Responsibilities of Cluster/Sector Leads & OCHA in Information Management, approved by the IASC in 2008.

Administrative Guidance

HIC 2.0 will rely on OCHA's administrative systems for recruiting and deploying staff and standby partners. This administrative system is housed in the OCHA office or UNDP structure at the country level. The administrative requirement includes the rapid deployment and recruitment of national and international staff, and the support and administrative management of these positions throughout the 3 to 12 month HIC 2.0 deployment timeline.

This system is clear for the recruitment and deployment of international staff but requires additional clarification in the area of national staff recruitment. HIC 2.0 will need to recruit national staff in Level 1 and Level 2 deployments within the first week of operations. These staff will need to be added to the IHP structure as National support staff, or be regularised within the OCHA or UNDP recruitment systems.

The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake the following actions to further develop the administrative support mechanism:

1. Develop **terms of reference for the HIC 2.0 Staffing Coordinator and Administrative Support positions** described in the organisational chart.
2. Analyse the **IHP national recruitment process** and determine if this system will meet OCHA needs.
3. Liaise with IHP to develop an **agreed process for national staff recruitment**.
4. Review **administrative procedures at the field level** with OCHA Administrative counterparts to ensure a clear understanding of the process for future HIC 2.0 deployments.

Detailed analysis of how to recruit and manage staff through OCHA mechanisms at the country level

HIC Handbook Revision

The original HIC Handbook collected and presented the responsibilities, tools and services that HICs provided in previous emergencies. This body of knowledge was then transferred to the Information Management Toolkit used in support of OCHA IMUs. Given the re-launch of the HIC system, the HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake a revision of the HIC Handbook reflecting the revised operating context, redesigned tools, and specific tasks around the Humanitarian Program Cycle and Transformative Agenda. The HIC 2.0 Management Cell should undertake this effort only after one Level 3 and several Level 1 and 2 HIC 2.0 deployments to gather current examples and ensure that the system is viable.

Networks and Partnerships

The HIC 2.0 system benefits from a series of previously established networks and partnership. These networks and partnerships range from IASC mandated bodies, standby partner NGOs/governments, and to formal/informal support mechanisms around disaster response and preparedness.

Current Networks

IM Working Group

The IMWG is a network of global focal points for information management that meet regularly in Geneva, with OCHA acting as secretariat. The IMWG has been kept apprised of OCHA's plans to reinstate the HIC and will be key in ensuring coordination with global cluster lead agencies and other key actors during the projects development and for future deployments.

Information Management Network

Established under the IASC operational guidance note, this country-level working group provides a forum for establishing data exchange standards, advocating for open data among organizations and creating a community of practice for IM professionals engaged in the response operation. HIC 2.0 will link this concept into a co-working space in future HICs.

Communicating with Disaster Affected Communities (CDAC) Network

The CDAC network puts two-way communication with disaster affected communities at the heart of a humanitarian response operation.²⁹ The HIC should explore and investigate this concept and use the network to collect and disseminate key information to the affected population.

Digital Humanitarian Network (DHN)

²⁹ <http://www.cdacnetwork.org/>

The DHN is a network-of-networks consortium of volunteer and technical communities to provide an interface between traditional humanitarian response entities and the evolving communities.³⁰ HIC 2.0 links to this group through the DHN Module, and establishes the group as part of the Additional Modules.

Current Partnerships

International Humanitarian Partnership (IHP)

The International Humanitarian Partnership is an informal network of several governmental organizations providing technical assistance in emergency response operations to the United Nations, the European Union and other international organizations³¹. Working with the IHP, OCHA has developed specific mechanisms to support UNDAC teams, and has recently developed a mechanism for IHP support to HICs. The IHP can provide various modules including base camps and information management modules in support of the HIC concept. Each support module contains equipment and staff, and is deployed and financed directly by the donor governments in support of OCHA's request for assistance.

Map Action

Map Action volunteers often deploy to provide mapping support to UNDAC teams in the field. Members of the 30-strong Map Action volunteer pool could also support an HIC at the field level for periods of up to three weeks at no cost to OCHA. The volunteers would require funding through MapAction or another mechanism to extend their deployments.

iMMAP

iMMAP "aims to alleviate the suffering of victims of natural and man-made disasters by providing decision-support services to national and international authorities and humanitarian agencies through the management of reliable, timely and appropriate strategic and geographic information."³² Through iMMAP, GIS experts have supported HICs and other OCHA operations.

Red R International

Red R maintains a Register of skilled professionals for United Nations agencies to call on for short-term emergency and disaster relief work. OCHA request staff with particular skills and RedR Australia nominates personnel from the Standby Register.

Norwegian Refugee Council (NRC)

The Norwegian Refugee Council is an independent, humanitarian, non-profit, non-governmental organisation which provides assistance, protection and durable solutions to refugees and internally displaced persons worldwide.

Swedish Civil Contingencies Agency (MSB)

The task of the MSB is to enhance and support societal capacities for preparedness for and prevention of emergencies and crises.

Irish Aid

Irish Aid is the Irish Government's program for overseas relief and development.

United Kingdom Department for International Development (DfID)

The Department for International Development co-ordinates the UK Government's response to humanitarian disasters and emergencies in developing and overseas countries. DfID was an early and strong supporter of the HIC concept providing direct funding, equipment grants and staff.

Canada's Civilian Reserve (Canadem)

Canadem is a non-profit agency dedicated to advancing international peace and security through the rostering, rapid mobilization, and mission management of experts committed to international service.

Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation (SDC)

³⁰ <http://digitalhumanitarians.com/>

³¹ <http://www.ihp.nu/>

³² www.immap.org

The Swiss Agency for Development and Cooperation (SDC) is Switzerland's international cooperation agency within the Federal Department of Foreign Affairs (FDFA). Among its roles, the SDC is responsible for the overall coordination of the humanitarian aid delivered by the Swiss Confederation.

Centre for International Peace Operations (ZIF)

The ZIF supports training and qualification and recruitment and support of civilian personnel for international peace operations and election monitoring missions by, among other things, developing and maintaining an expert roster of qualified German personnel.

Iceland Crisis Response Unit (ICRU)

The ICRU provides staff for relief, development, peace-keeping operations.

Qatar Charity

Qatar Charity is a non-governmental organization, founded in 1992 for the development of the Qatari society and other needy communities.

Networks and Partnership Approach for HIC 2.0

Significant networks and partnerships exist through OCHA mechanisms to support HIC 2.0 in initial deployments. However, major work remains to analyse these relationships in the context of HIC 2.0 and update these partnerships accordingly.

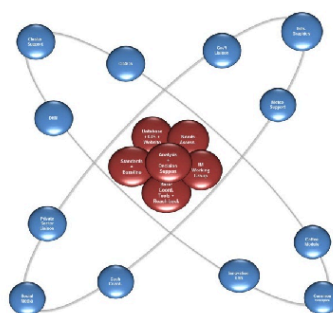
The majority of the current partnerships fall under OCHA Standby Partner arrangements. These are essential to the HIC's success by providing a pool of skilled information responders during HIC 2.0 deployments. In addition to a capacity assessment and capacity support through increasing numbers of HIC 2.0 ready staff, the HIC 2.0 Management Cell must look beyond these traditional partners to recruit and retain a new set of partnerships in support of its mission.

Just as the profiles within the HIC 2.0 have evolved past the traditional database and mapping profile of the original HIC staff, so must the partnerships grow with the changing context. HIC 2.0 needs an expanded network that includes specific organizations, companies and individuals with the skills needed to update the HIC 2.0 modules and staff a HIC through virtual and physical deployment. Given the increasing competition for information management professionals within the traditional talent pools, HIC 2.0 must look outside these existing partnerships to build multi-skilled capacity that is consistently deployed at the field level.

Figure 13: HIC 2.0 Existing & New Networks and Partnerships

New and Needed Networks and Partnerships

Professional Head Hunting Firms
Digital Volunteer Networks
Common Workspace Enthusiasts
Web Design Groups
Private Sector Expertise
Data Graphics Networks
New Humanitarian Actors (WMO)
Tech Innovation Centres
Technology Clusters
Information Professional Networks
Academia (Professors, institutions, students)



HIC 2.0

Existing Networks and Partnerships

Nat'l Response (MSB etc.)
NGOs (iMMAP etc.)
IHP
Standby Partner Systems
IM Working Group (global)
IM Network (field)
CDACs Network

Sources for these new networks and partnerships would include academia, private sector enterprise focusing on web based information companies. For example, instead of relying on standby partners from national disaster response agencies who may have basic experience in info graphics, HIC 2.0 should forge partnerships with professional design agencies to encourage physical and virtual deployments in support of the Info Graphics Module.

Changing the way the HIC 2.0 operates in today's world means changing the pool of available talent, and updating the networks and partnerships that support the HIC 2.0 system. This will be an incremental process of identifying and developing key relationships over time.

HIC 2.0 Governance

The 2008 HIC Terms of Reference establishes clear responsibility for HIC implementation. While OCHA's Senior Management are directly responsible for implementing the activities described in the TOR, OCHA is also tasked with establishing a Stakeholder Steering committee at the global level to represent the entire humanitarian community:

"To this end, OCHA is to establish a Stakeholder Steering Committee at the global level, representative of the international humanitarian community who can provide governance of the HIC to ensure that it is in compliance with the common service orientation of this Terms of Reference. The Stakeholder Steering Committee is requested to periodically report to the IASC WG on a biannual basis, a status report on the implementation of this Terms of Reference³³."

This instruction is based on the HIC status as a Humanitarian Common Service, and places HIC users in the humanitarian community at large as responsible for overseeing TOR implementation and reporting on the status of the HIC system. The steering committee was activated to produce the HIC Terms of Reference but was never used as a governance tool. Given this directive, OCHA should consider activating this steering committee to guide the development of the HIC 2.0 process.

Funding HIC 2.0

The level of funding that HIC 2.0 receives will determine the level and quality of the services it can produce. Adequate funding, paired with proper management will lead to a successful re-launch and continued quality service over time. Donors have proven a willingness to fund HIC programming in the past and have indicated a continued willingness to fund future information management services. The HIC will continue to attract funding by adding value through its services.

³³ Terms of Reference for Humanitarian Information Centers, IASC Approved 2008.

Given the unified cost plan approach within OCHA, it will be essential that adequate funding is channelled to the HIC Management Cell and to the HIC at the country level.

Given these factors, OCHA Information Services Branch (ISB) should undertake the following initiatives:

1. Build understanding of HIC 2.0's **added value to OCHA** within the organisation, then leverage that support to deliver key messages about required HIC 2.0 funding to the highest levels.
2. Clearly link the ability to deliver HIC 2.0 Modules (functions, products, and services) to **required funding**.
3. Ensure that the **first HIC 2.0 deployment is a success**, preferably in a natural disaster scenario with few limits.

If these efforts do not result in clear agreements at all levels of the organisation around funding for HIC 2.0, then consider reverting to a separate cost plan funded directly by donors in each emergency.

Yearly Deployment Outlook

In order to plan for funding, staff, and equipment levels, the HIC Management Cell should undertake a planning exercise to project the number and level of expected HIC deployments. These figures could help determine a yearly contingency scenario. The outcome of the analysis should resemble the following:

Level 3 HIC Deployments @ 1

Level 2 HIC Deployments @ 2

Level 1 HIC Deployments @ 3

Protracted emergencies @ 5 to 10 on going (Note: illustrative, not based on analysis)

The Management Cell should review historical data found on the UNDAC Mission Table³⁴ and determine a hypothetical number of previous HIC deployments based on the HIC 2.0 concept. The Cell could then identify trends and establish projections to support the planning process. The Cell should also undertake a geographical analysis to identify trends in deployment location.

Advocacy Materials

Advocacy materials targeting senior management will demonstrate the added value of HIC 2.0 Modules and link these functions to specific costs at the field and management level. These advocacy tools will be based on the completed HIC 2.0 blueprint document, and should include the following elements:

- Compelling stories about past HIC success and the effects of non-deployment in the Haiti Earthquake response and in the Pakistan 2010 flood response.
- The impact of under-resourced information management systems within OCHA.
- Clear info graphics on HIC 2.0 structure and modules.
- A summary of the various costs associated with HIC 2.0 deployment (field level and management)

The timeframe for completing and undertaking the activities is urgent. It will be advantageous to complete the advocacy process before OCHA is asked to deploy a HIC in the field.

Conclusion

The HIC 2.0 Blueprint document provides a plan for the re-designed Humanitarian Information Centre. The document details ISS current thinking on how the HIC of the future should operate to meet field level information coordination challenges. Now that the HIC 2.0 design is established, the task of securing conceptual and financial support for the HIC begins.

While the HIC 2.0 falls within existing TORs and complements former OCHA information management systems, the HIC 2.0 system provides a sophisticated response to today's humanitarian response environment. Future HICs are designed to deliver analytical support by providing consistent information coordination services in support of the Humanitarian Program Cycle.

³⁴ Found at <http://ochanet.unocha.org/p/Documents/LATEST%20UNDAC%20Missions%20Table.pdf>

Project Implementation Plan and Next Steps

- I. **Organisational Change Processes**
 - a. Secure buy-in from Chief, OCHA Information Services Section (ISS).
 - b. Secure buy-in from Chief, OCHA Information Services Branch (ISB).
 - c. Secure Buy-in from Chief of Operations, Coordination and Response Division (CRD).
 - d. Conduct awareness campaign with OCHA Heads of Office (global).
- II. **Funding Processes**
 - a. Continue to allocate existing funds to HIC 2.0 development.
 - b. Make adjustments in support of the HIC 2.0 Management Cell in the 2013 Mid-Year Cost Plan Amendment.
 - c. Include HIC 2.0 Management Cell in ISB 2014/beyond cost plans.
 - d. Sensitise donors on HIC 2.0 added value.
- III. **Operational Processes**
 - a. Continue operational planning for one or more HIC 2.0 deployment in 2013 by following the plans in the Blueprint document.
 - b. Ensure the first HIC 2.0 deployment is successful to re-establish the HIC brand.
 - c. Continue to elaborate equipment needs and clarify IHP and OCHA ITS support role.

Annex 1: Sample Cost Plans

Sample Cost Plan Level 3 HIC 2.0, Review in Excel, then add

Sample Cost Plan Level 2 HIC 2.0 Review in Excel, then add

Sample Cost Plan Level 1 HIC 2.0 Review in Excel, then add